



Computational imaging

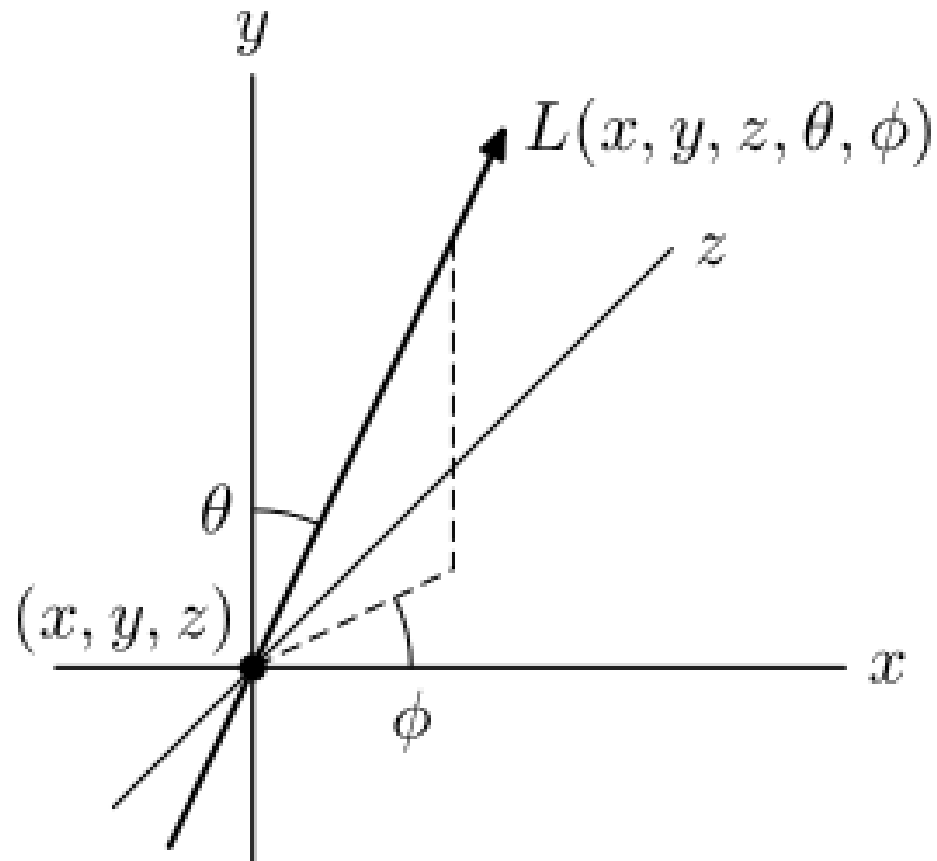
Taras Holotyak

Content

- Computational photography
- Light field photography
- Conventional camera with coded aperture

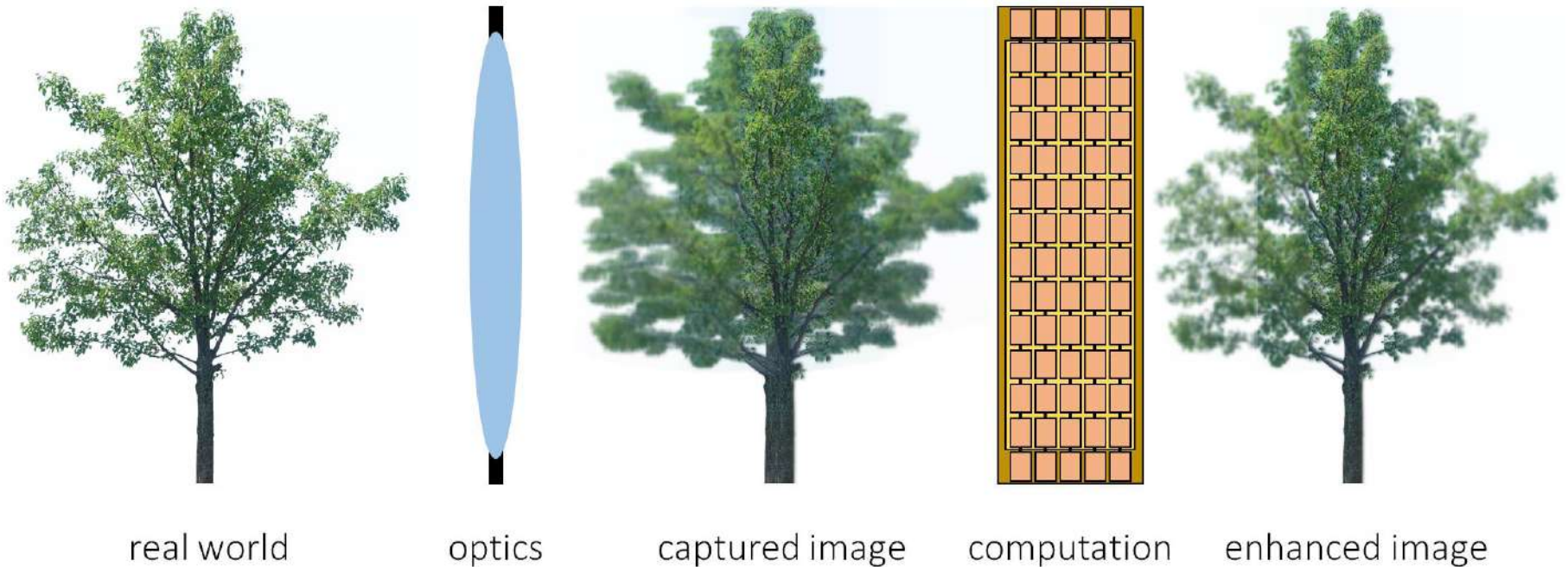
Computational photography

Imaging model



Computational photography

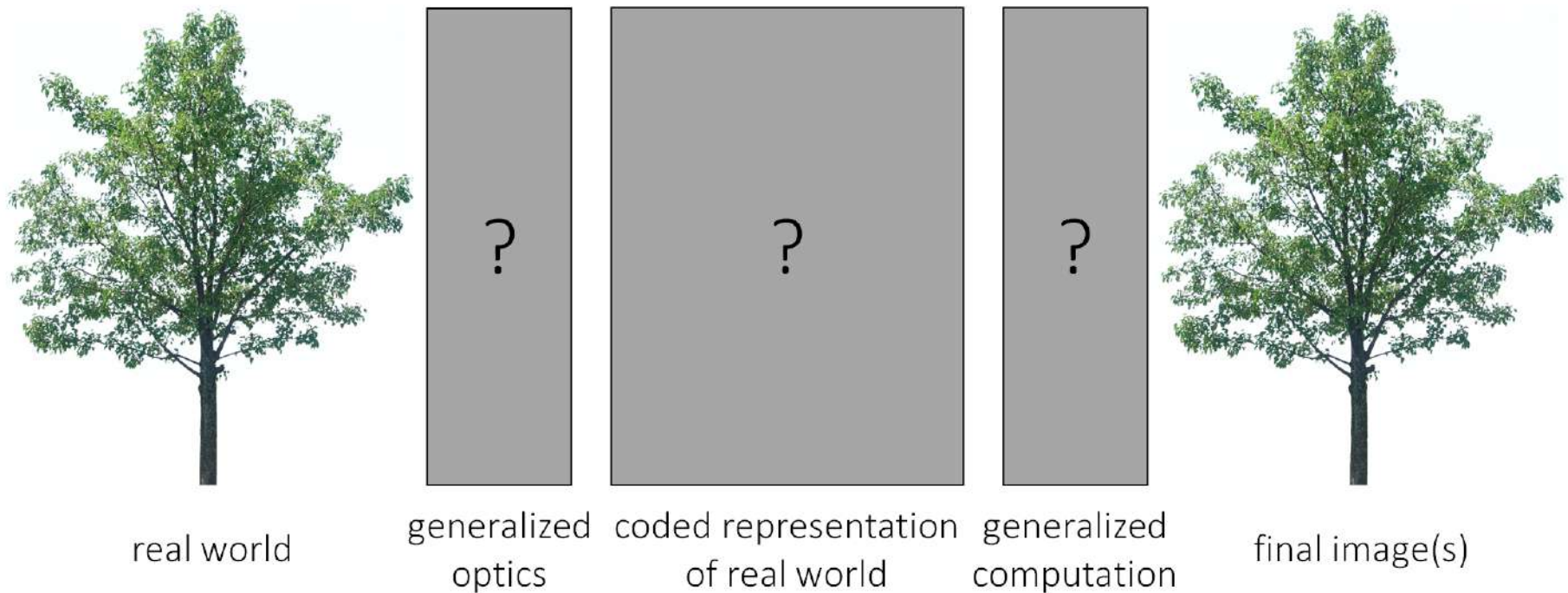
Conventional photography



- Optics capture something that is (close to) the final image.
- Computation mostly “enhances” captured image (e.g., deblur).

Computational photography

Computational photography



- Generalized optics encode world into intermediate representation.
- Generalized computation decodes representation into multiple images.

Computational photography

- optics
- aperture
- depth of field
- field of view
- exposure
- noise
- color filter arrays
- image processing pipeline

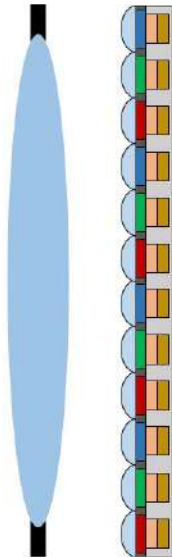


Computational photography

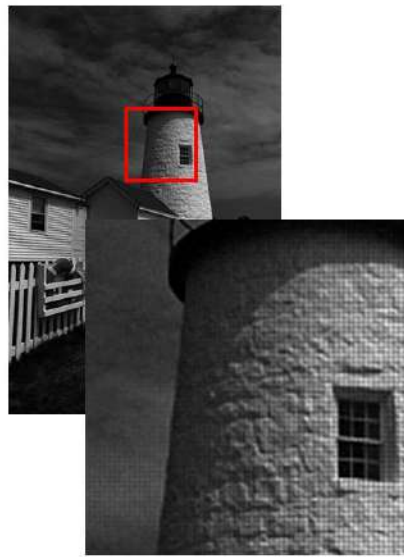
Early example: mosaicing



real world



generalized
optics



coded representation
of real world



generalized
computation

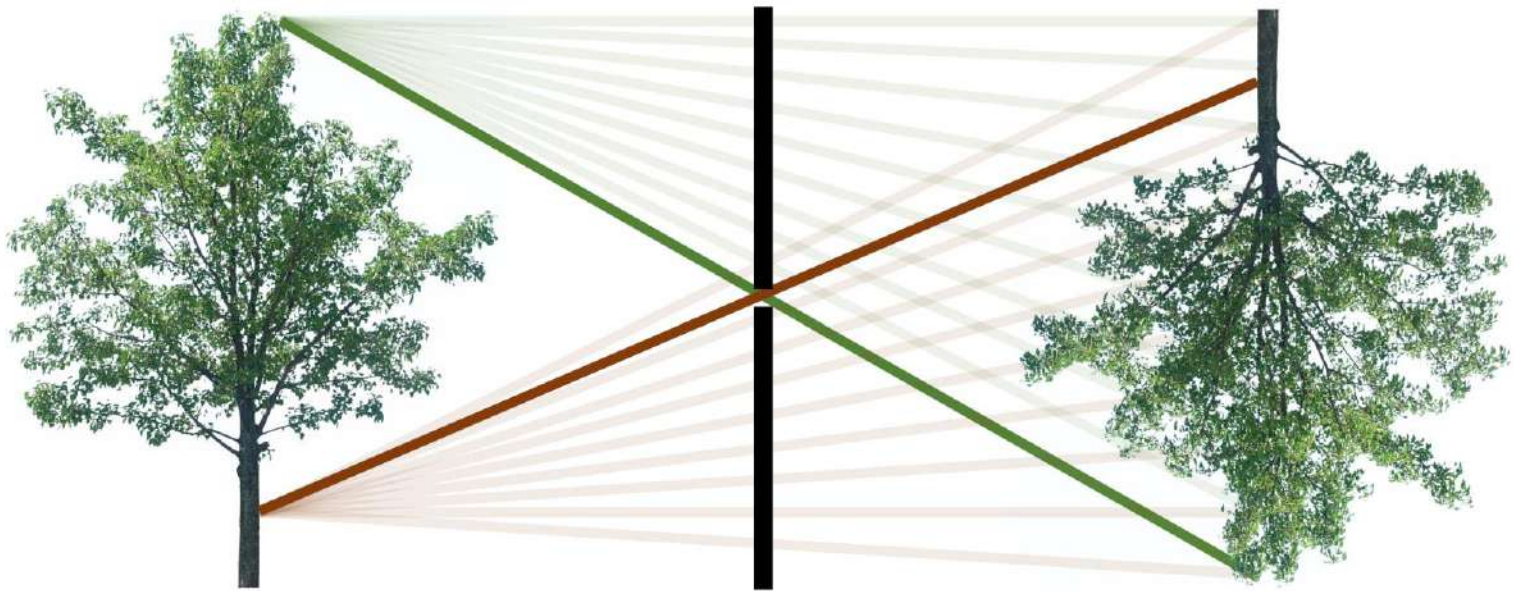


final image(s)

- Color filter array encodes color into a mosaic.
- Demosaicing decodes color into RGB image.

Computational photography

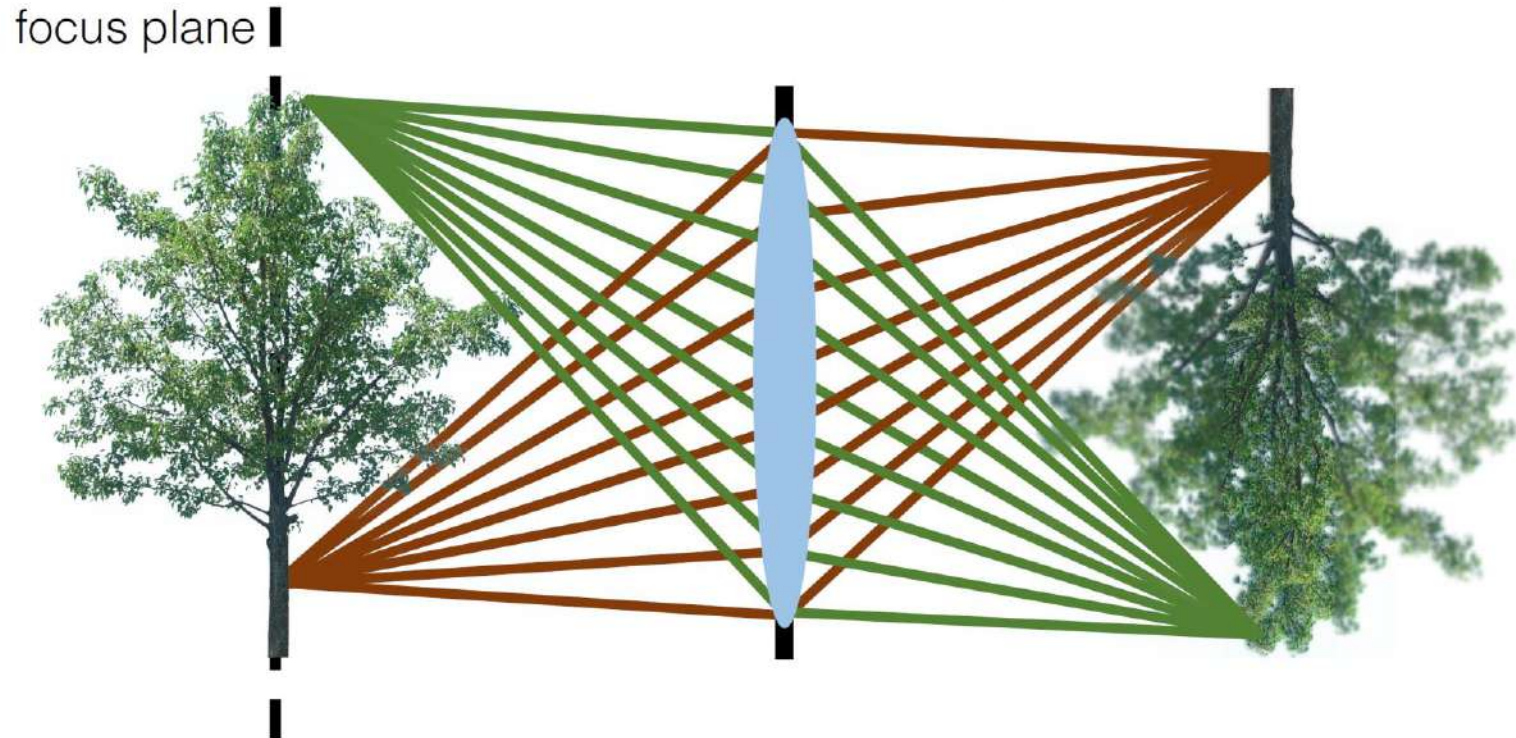
Pinhole camera



- Everything is in focus.
- Very light inefficient.

Computational photography

Lens camera

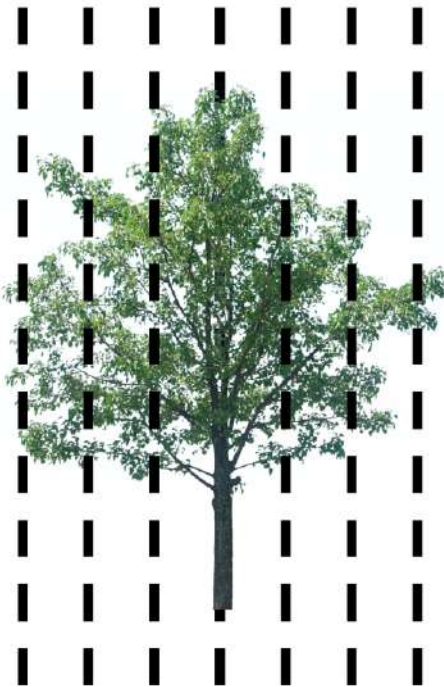


- Only one plane is in focus.
- Very light efficient.

How can we get an all in-focus image?

Computational photography

Focal stack



- Capture images focused at multiple planes.
- Merge them into a single all in-focus image.

- Analogous to what we did in HDR
- Focal stack instead of exposure stack.

Computational photography

Focal stack imaging

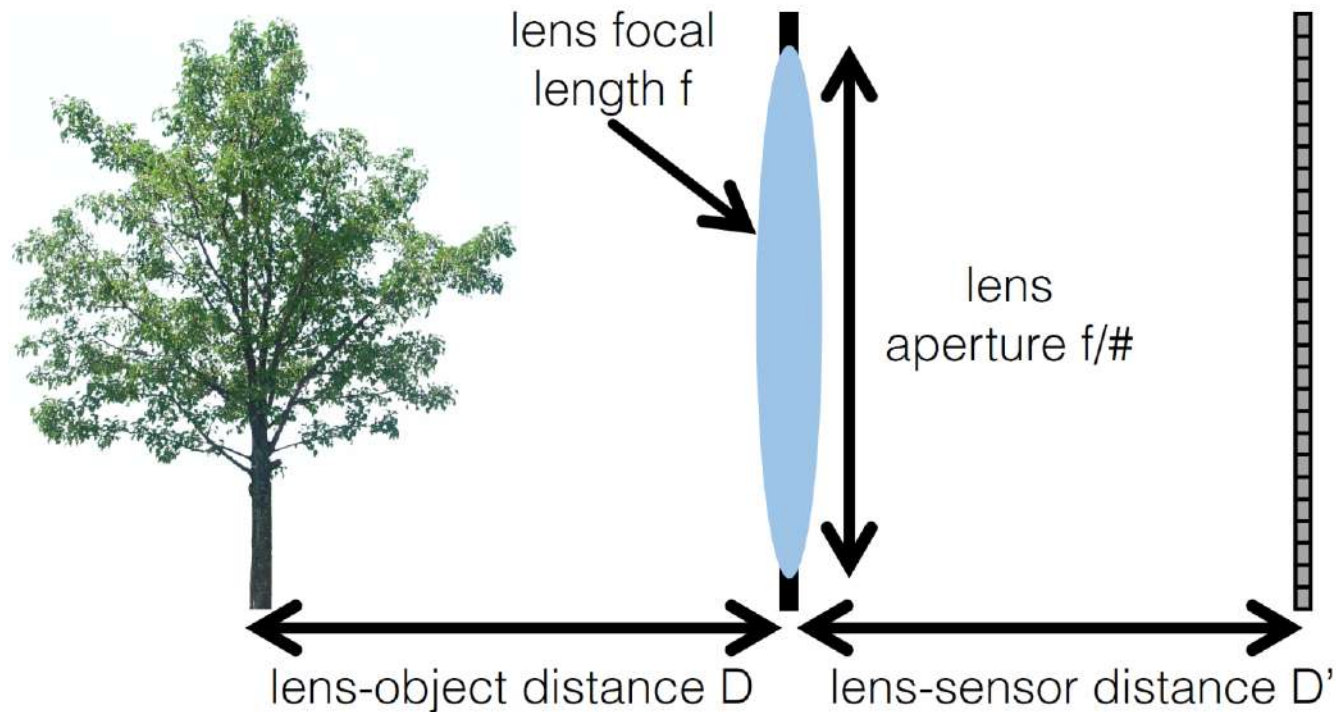
1. Capture a focal stack



2. Merge into an all in-focus image

Computational photography

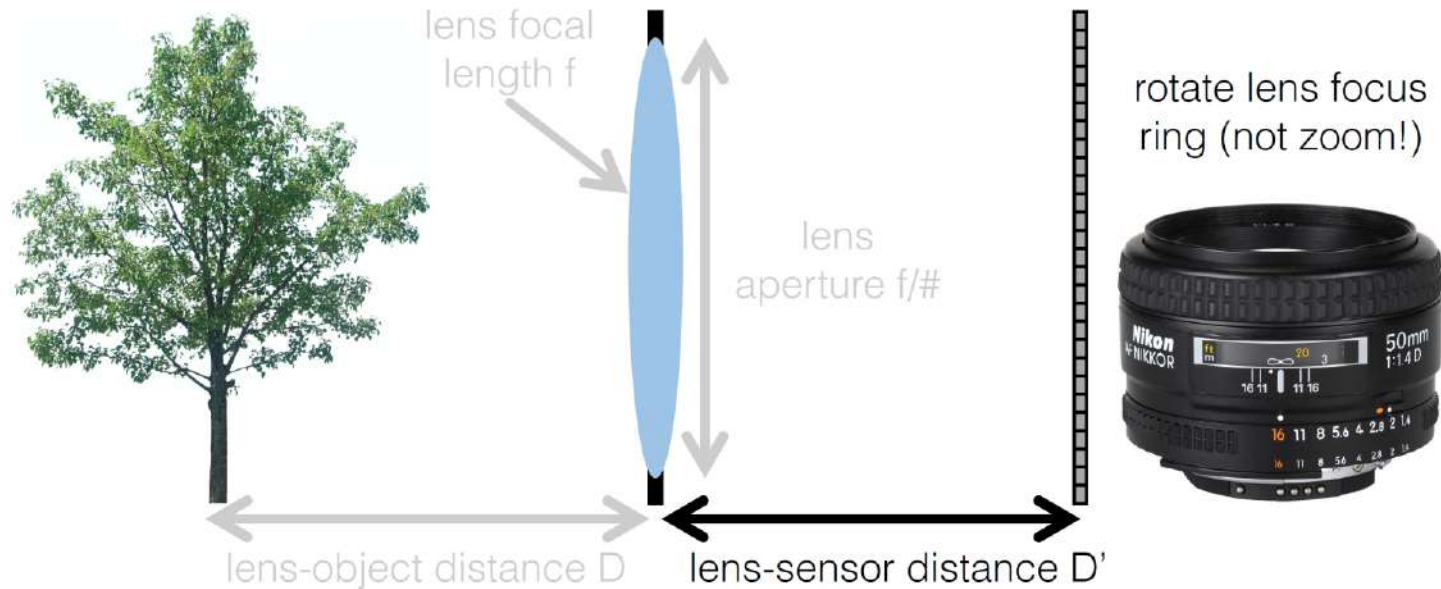
How do you capture a focal stack?



Which of these parameters would you change (and how)?

Computational photography

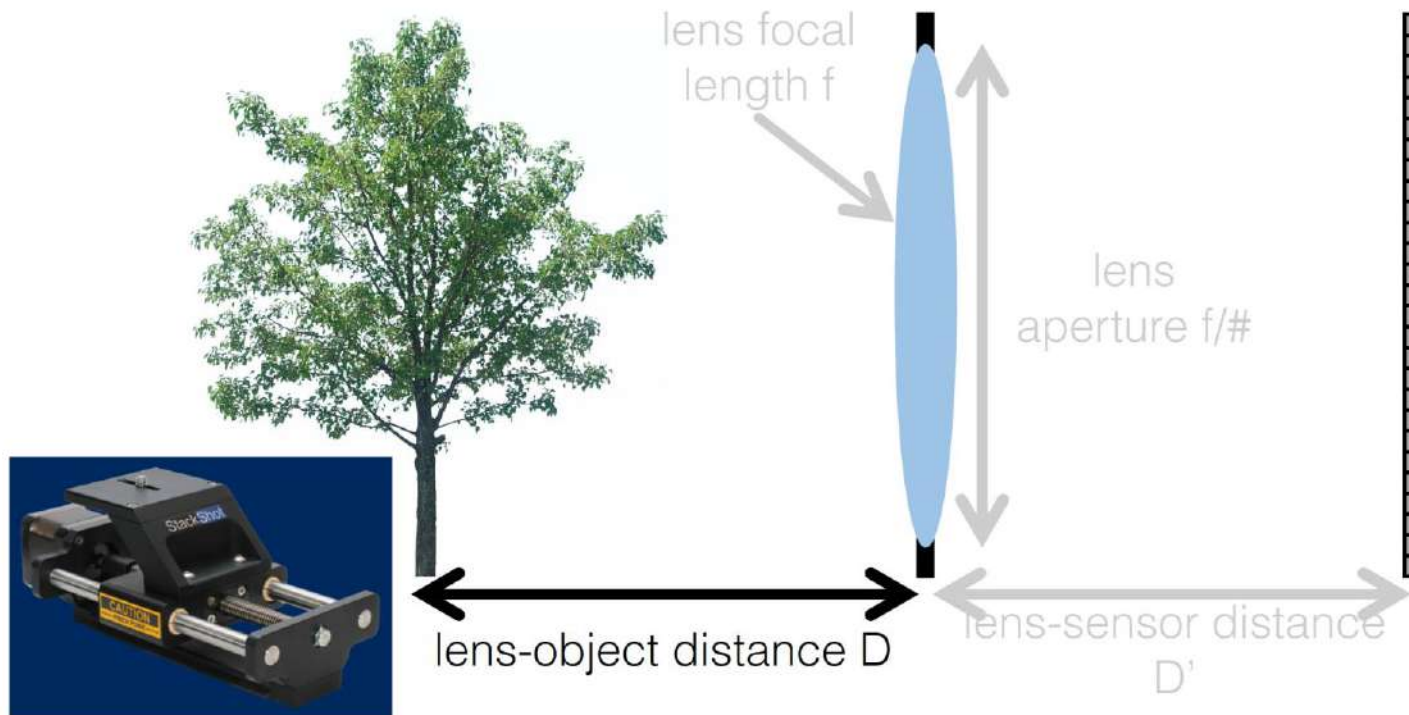
How do you capture a focal stack?



Which of these parameters would you change (and how)?

Computational photography

How do you capture a focal stack?



Which of these parameters would you change (and how)?

Computational photography

How do you merge a focal stack?

1. Align images
2. Assign per-pixel weights representing “in-focus”-ness
3. Compute image average

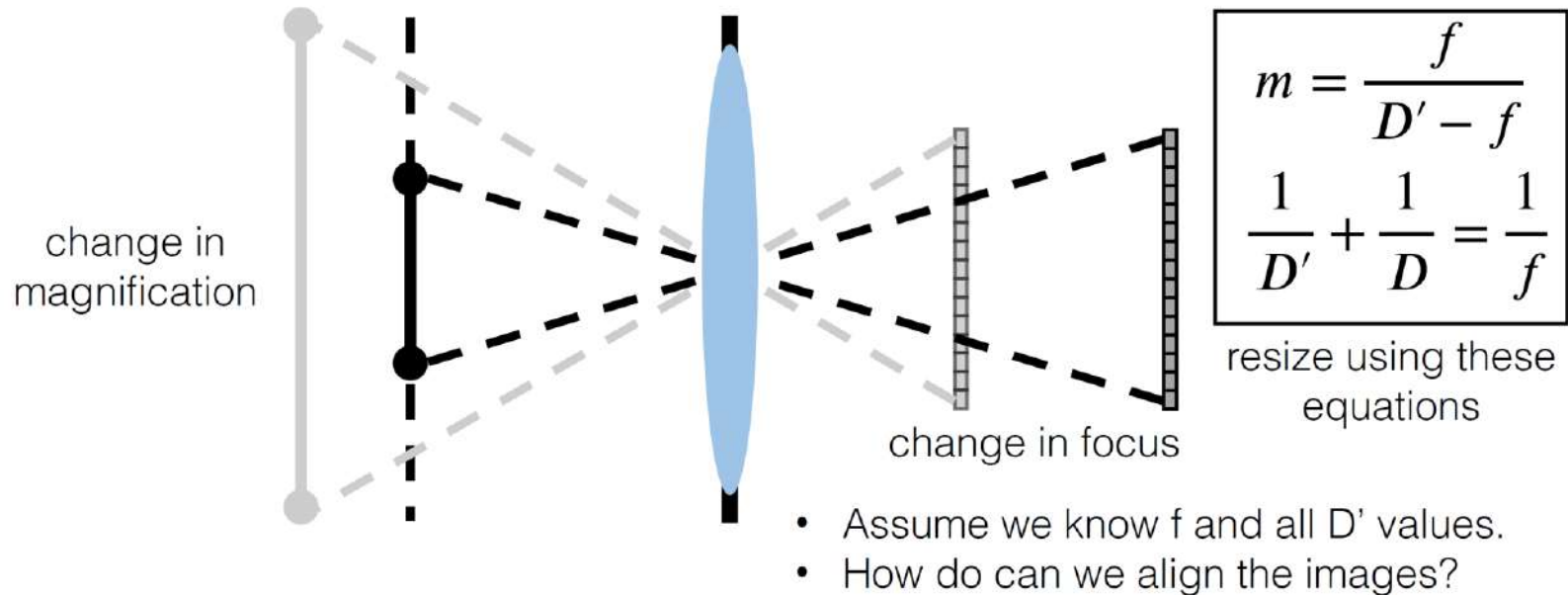


Computational photography

Image alignment

Why do we need to align the images?

- When we change focus distance, we also change field of view (magnification).
- Also, scene may not be static (but we will be ignoring this for now).



Computational photography

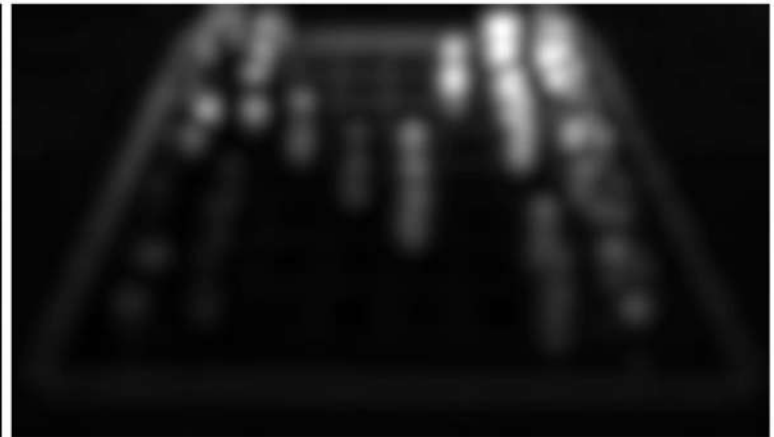
Weight assignment

How do we measure how much “in-focus” each pixel is?

- Measure local sharpness.



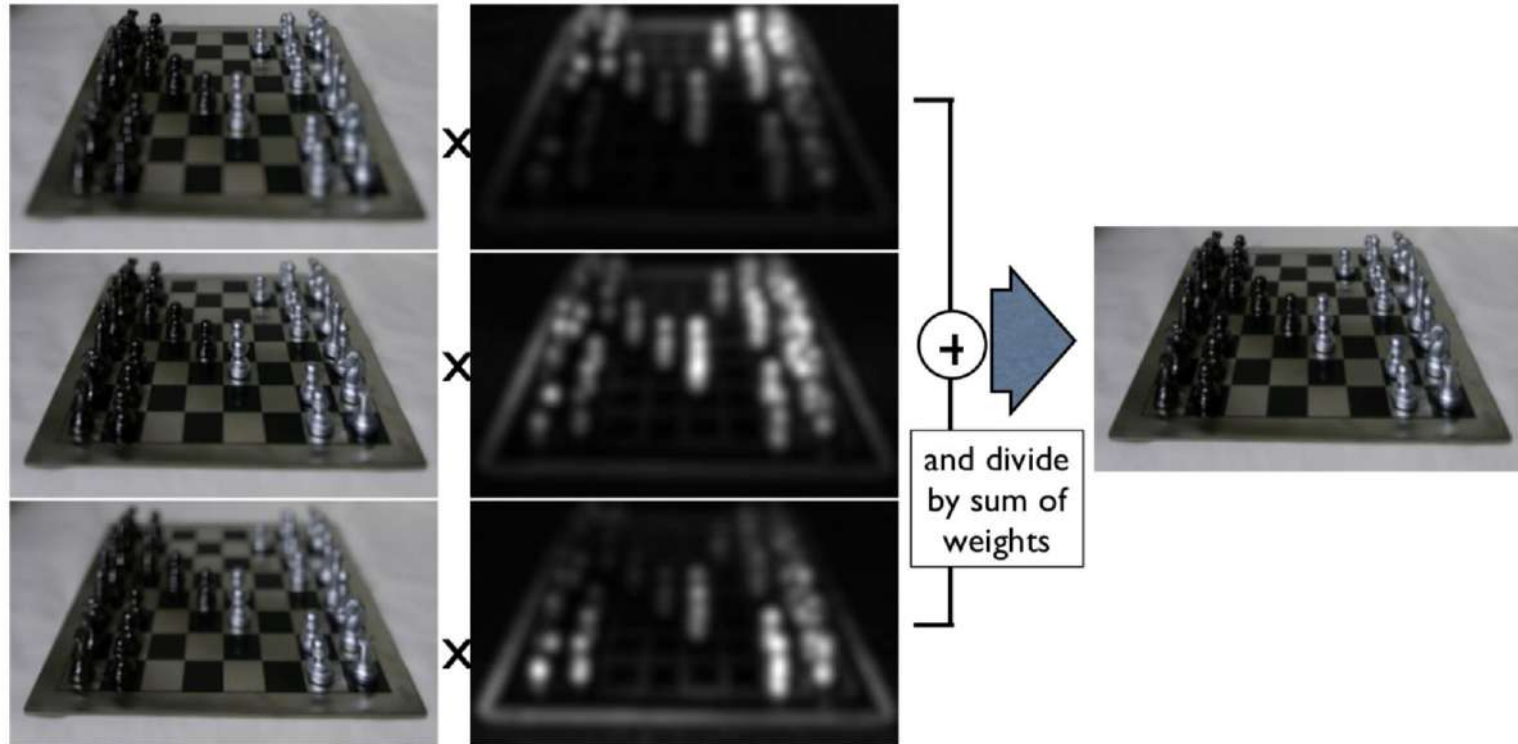
run Laplacian operator



do some Gaussian blurring

Computational photography

Focal stack merging



Computational photography



example image from stack



all in-focus image



middle image from stack



all in-focus image

Computational photography

Confocal stereo

- Capture a 2D stack by varying both focus and aperture
- Analyze each pixel's focus-aperture image to find true depth



[Hassinof and Kutulakos, ECCV 2006]

Computational photography

Depth from defocus

What if we have two images with different defocus?

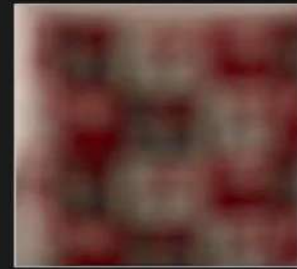


$f(x, y)$

*



=



$g_1(x, y)$



$f(x, y)$

*



=



$g_2(x, y)$

[Shree K. Nayar]

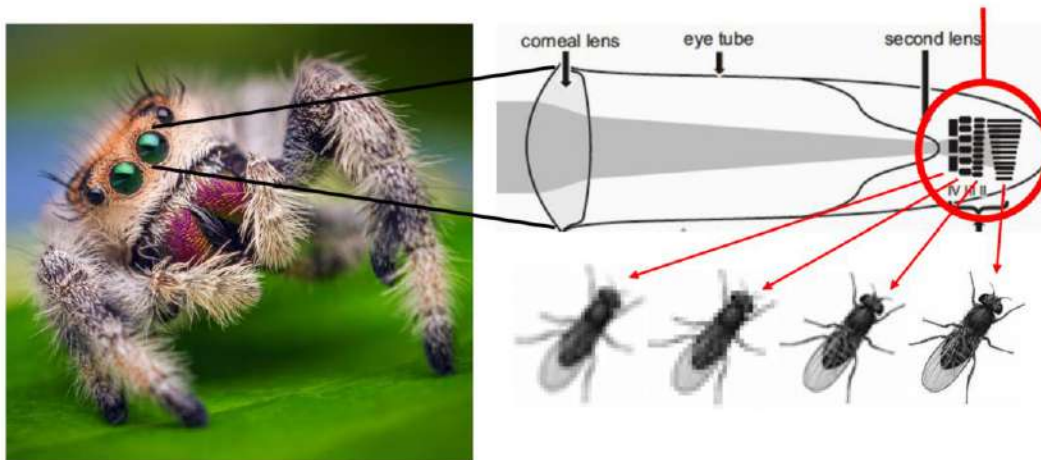
Computational photography

Focal flow

Use a dense focal stack (e.g., from autofocus):

- Assume circle of confusion can be modeled as (typically Gaussian) blur kernel with varying σ .
- Estimate optical flow between successive frames in focal stack.
- Relate optical flow change to depth.

Requires very little computation (no convolutions) but only works on textured patches (why?).



Biologically-inspired from jumping spiders!

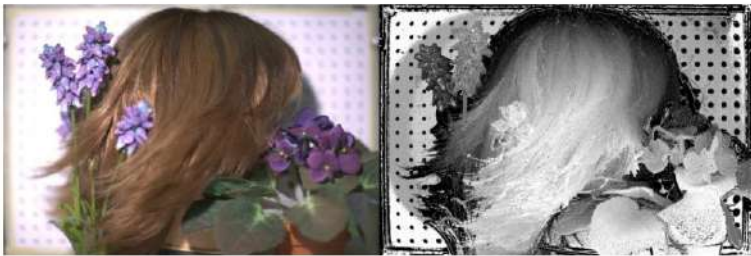
[Alexander et al., ECCV 2016; Guo et al., ICCV 2017, PNAS 2019]

Computational photography

Depth inference techniques

Confocal stereo:

- Requires focus-aperture stack.
- Gives per-pixel depth estimates.



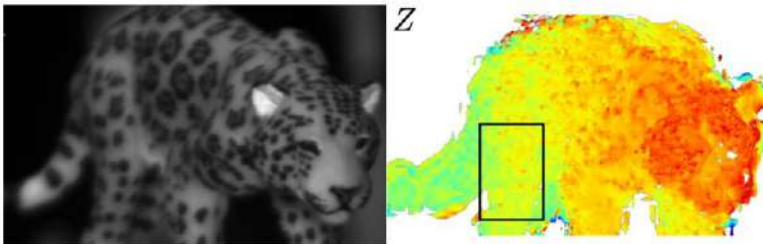
Depth from focus:

- Requires focus stack.
- Gives per-patch depth estimates.



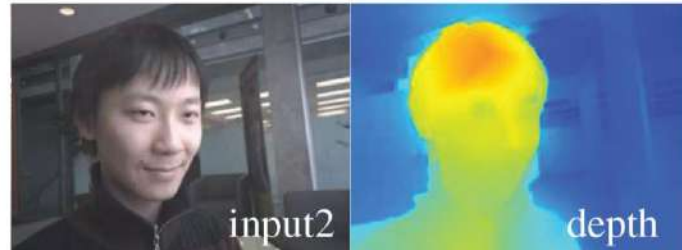
Focal flow:

- Requires dense focus stack.
- Efficient per-patch depth estimates.



Depth from defocus:

- Requires only two images.
- Gives per-patch depth estimates.



Light field photography

Light Field Theory

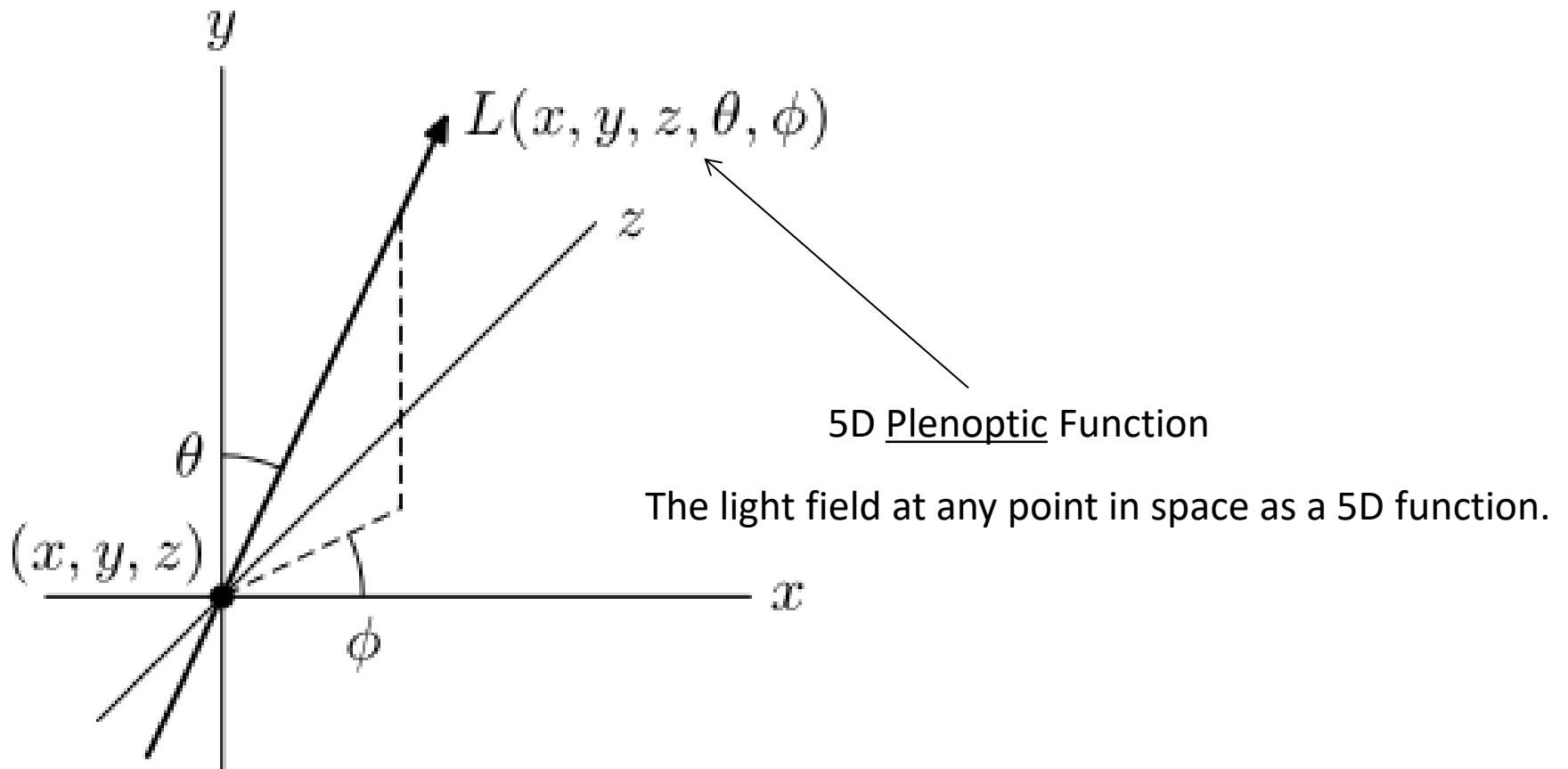
Photographs do not record most of the information about the light entering the camera.

Light field cameras show how light coming from one part of the lens differs from the light coming from another. (Vectors of light, where they originate, and how they are manipulated using lenses)

Light fields are defined in a couple different ways, one is as the geometrical distribution of light rays flowing in space.

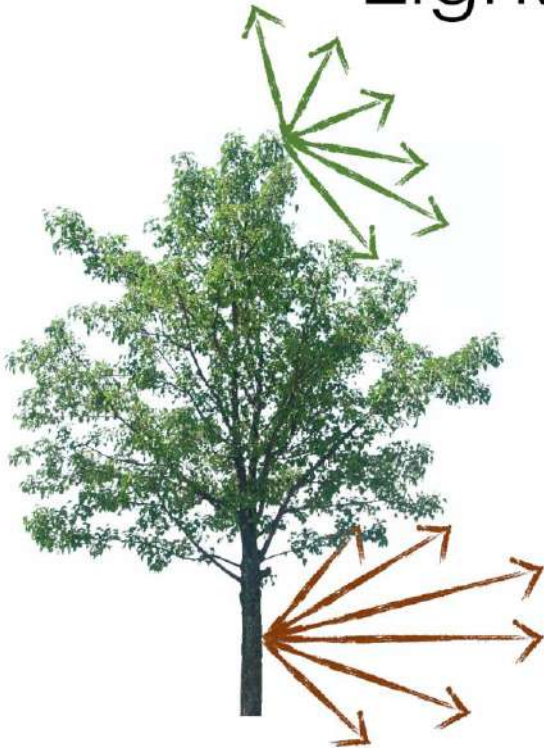
The total geometric distribution of light as a plenoptic function over the 5D space of rays – 3D for each spatial position and 2D for each direction of flow.

Light field photography



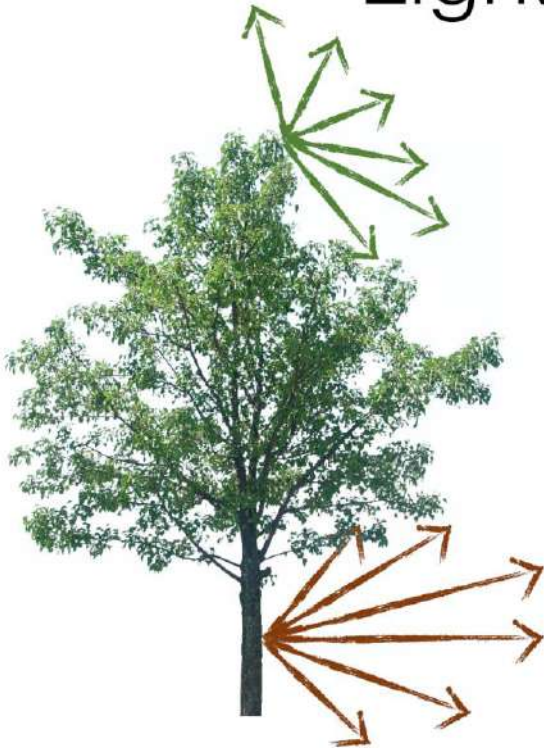
Light field photography

Light field (radiance)



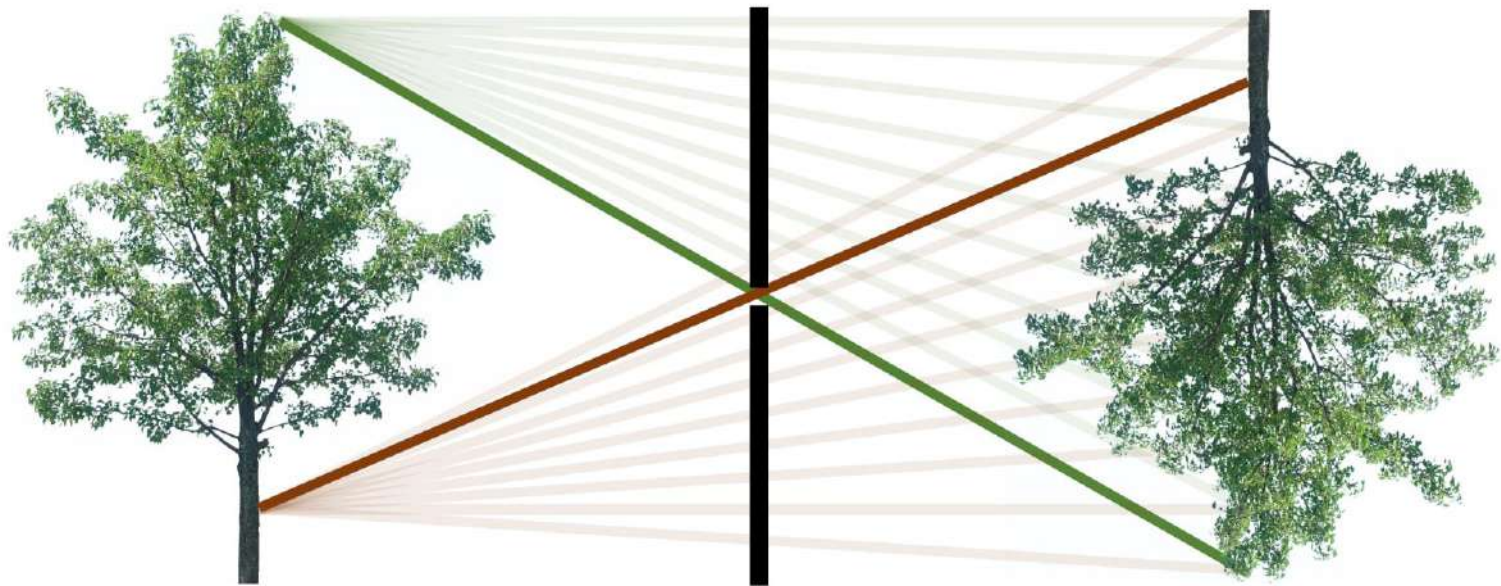
Light field photography

Light field (radiance)



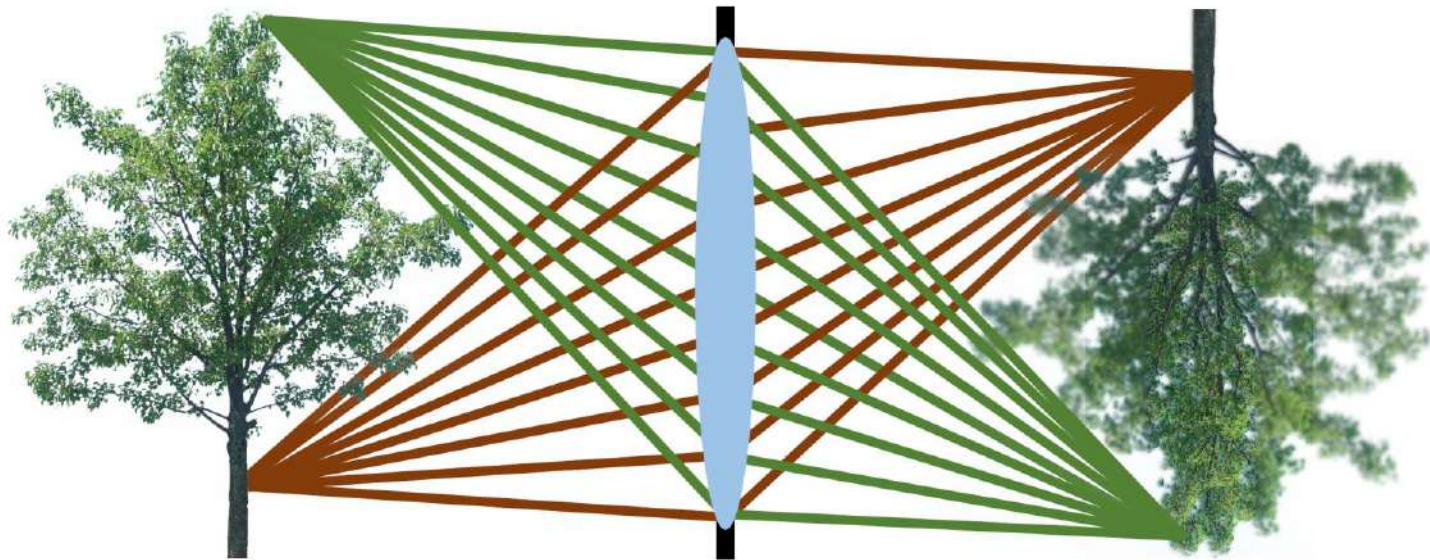
Light field photography

Pinhole camera



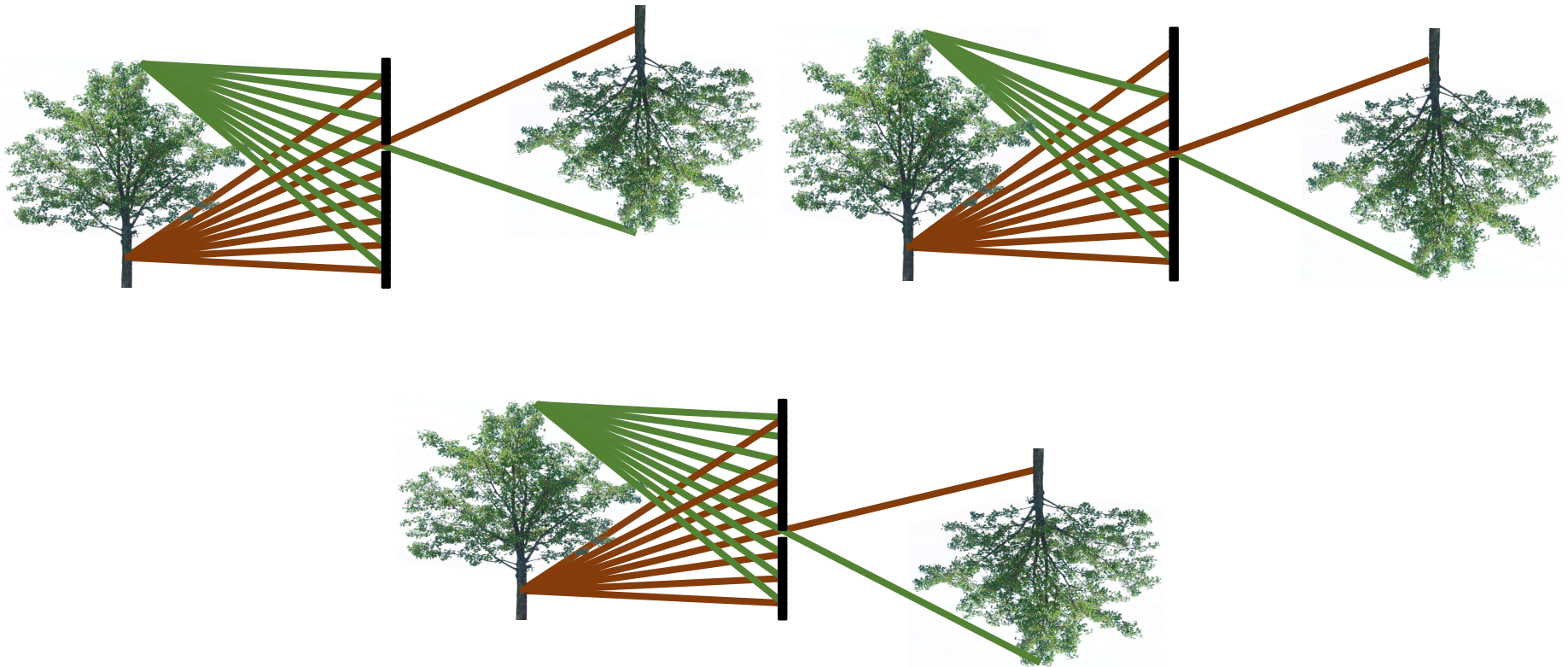
Light field photography

Measuring rays



Light field photography

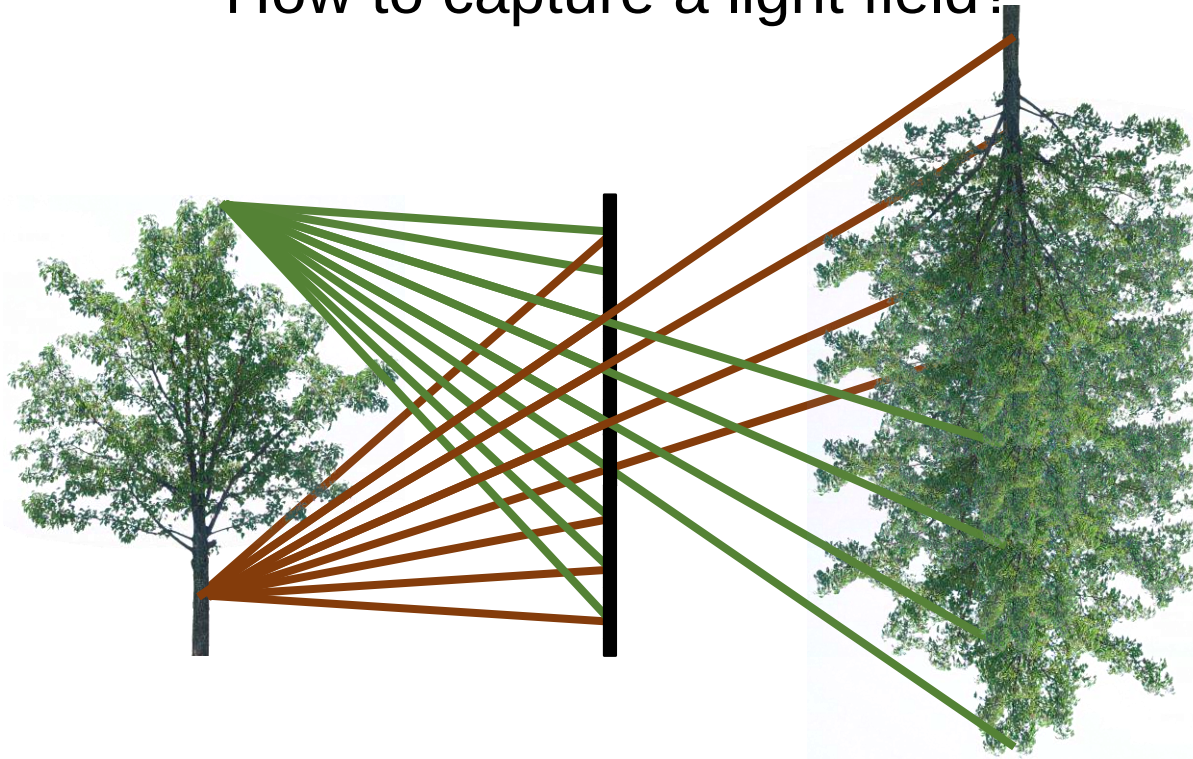
Measuring rays



The same set of rays can be captured by using a pinhole camera from multiple viewpoints

Light field photography

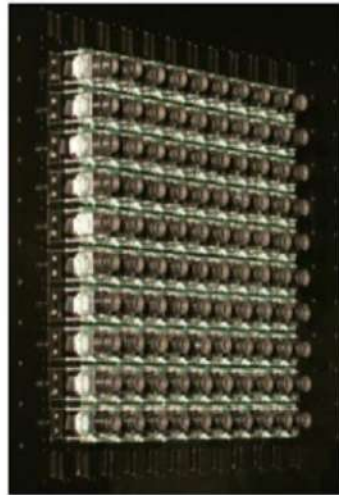
How to capture a light field?



Light field photography

Option 1: use multiple cameras

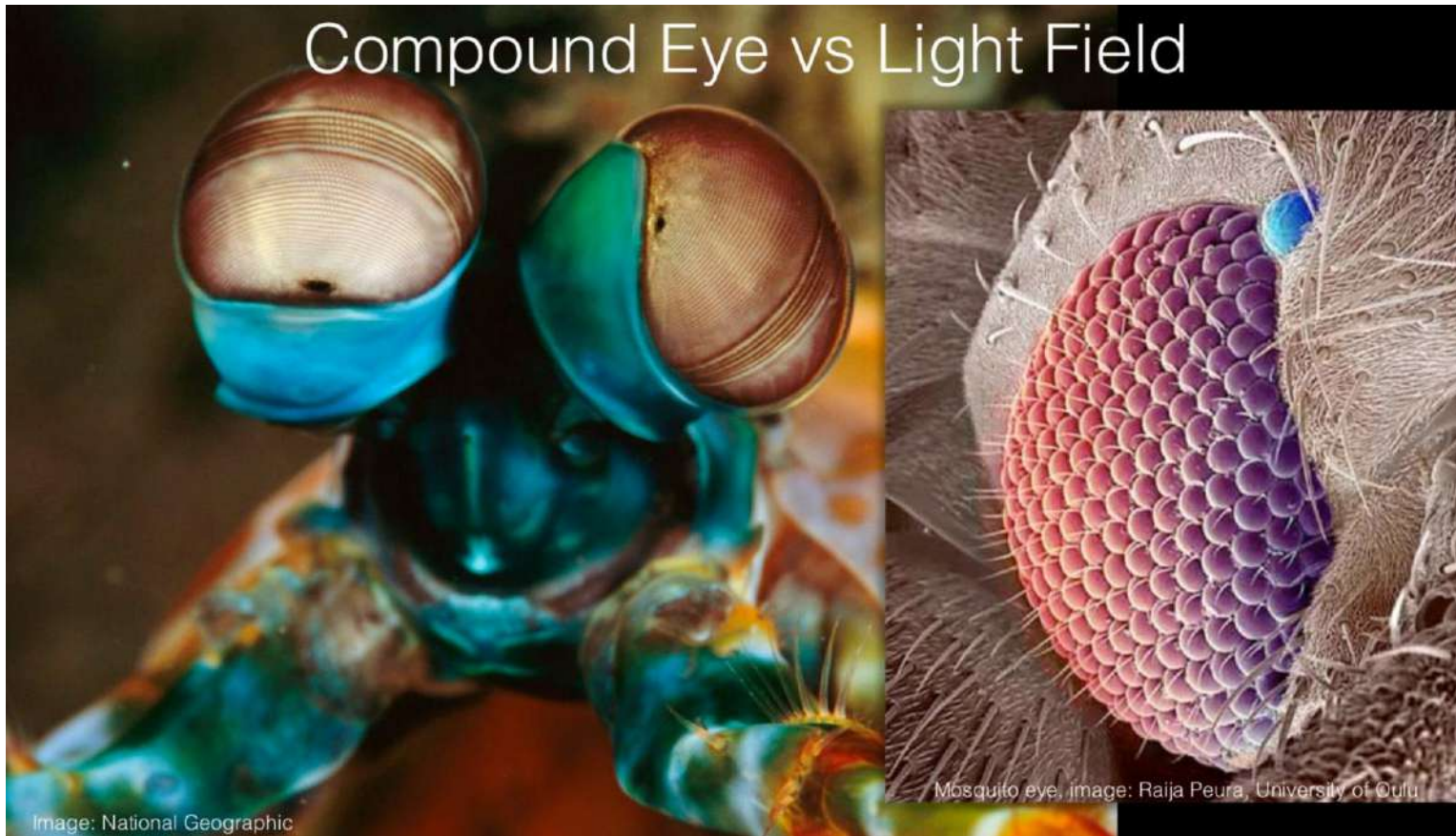
Stanford camera array



(“synthetic aperture”)

[Willburn et al., SIGGRAPH 2005]

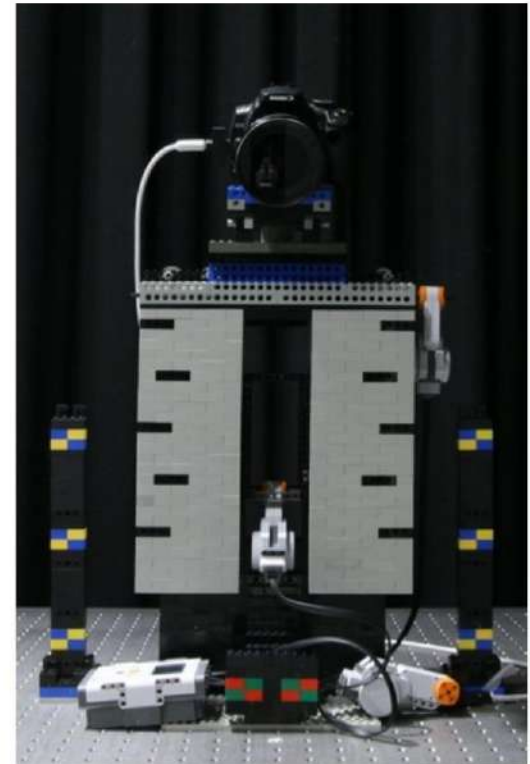
Light field photography



Light field photography

Option 2: take multiple images with one camera

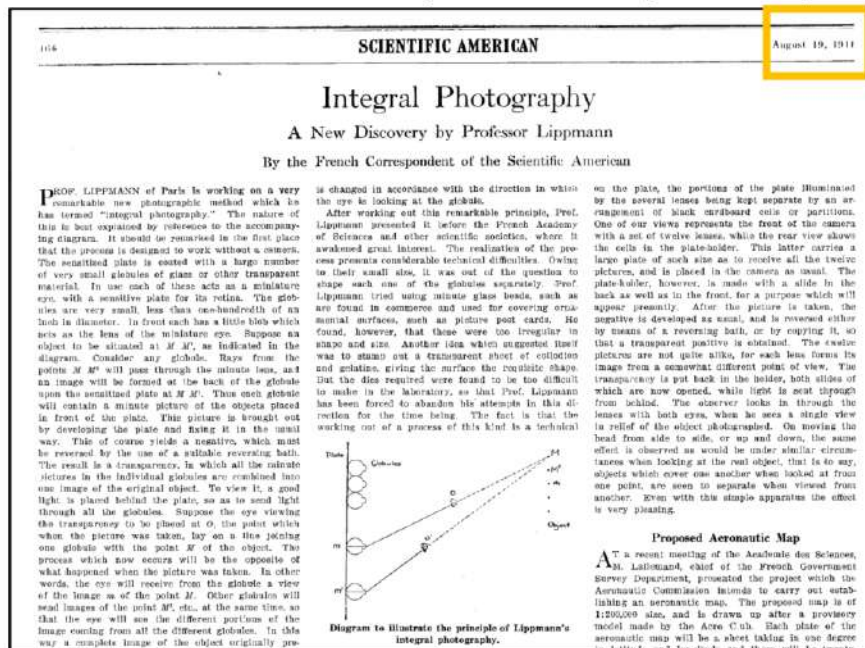
Single camera mounted on LEGO motor.



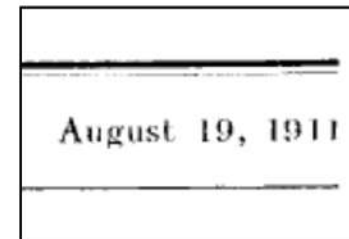
Light field photography

Option 3: use a plenoptic camera

plenoptic = plenus (Latin for “full”) + optic (Greek for “seeing”, in this case)



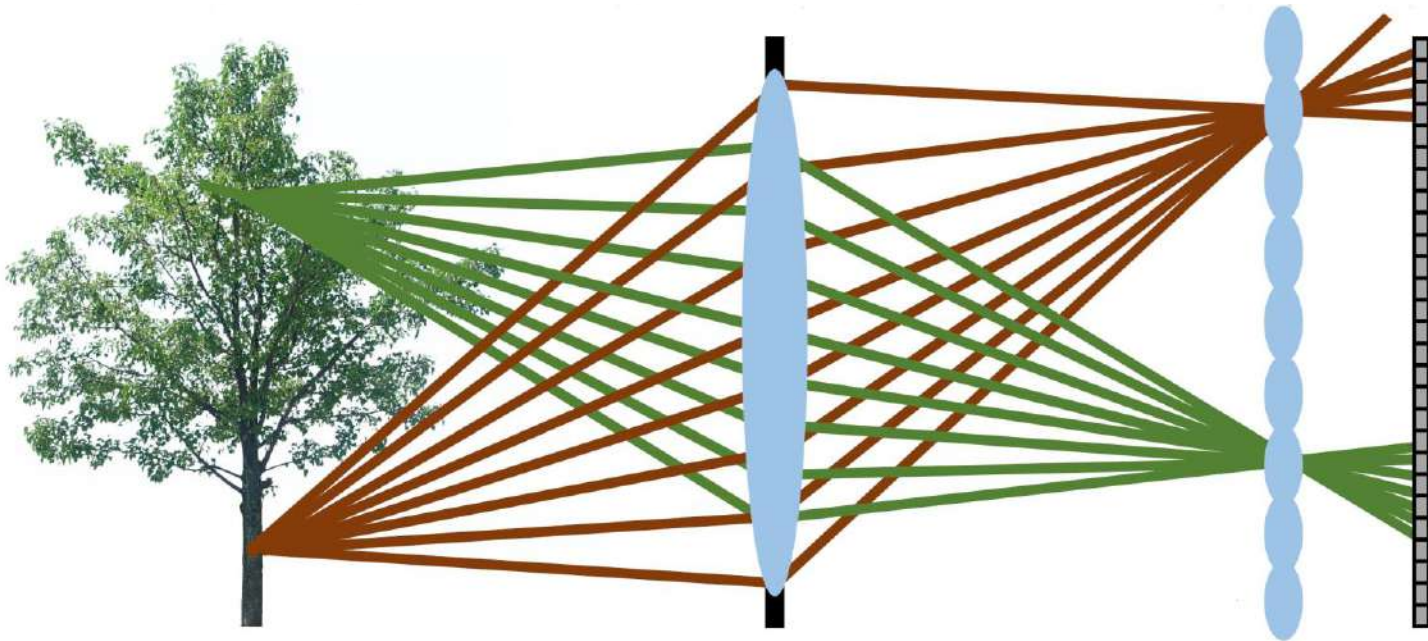
First conceptualized by Gabriel Lippmann, who called it integral photography.



Notice the date: more than a century ago.

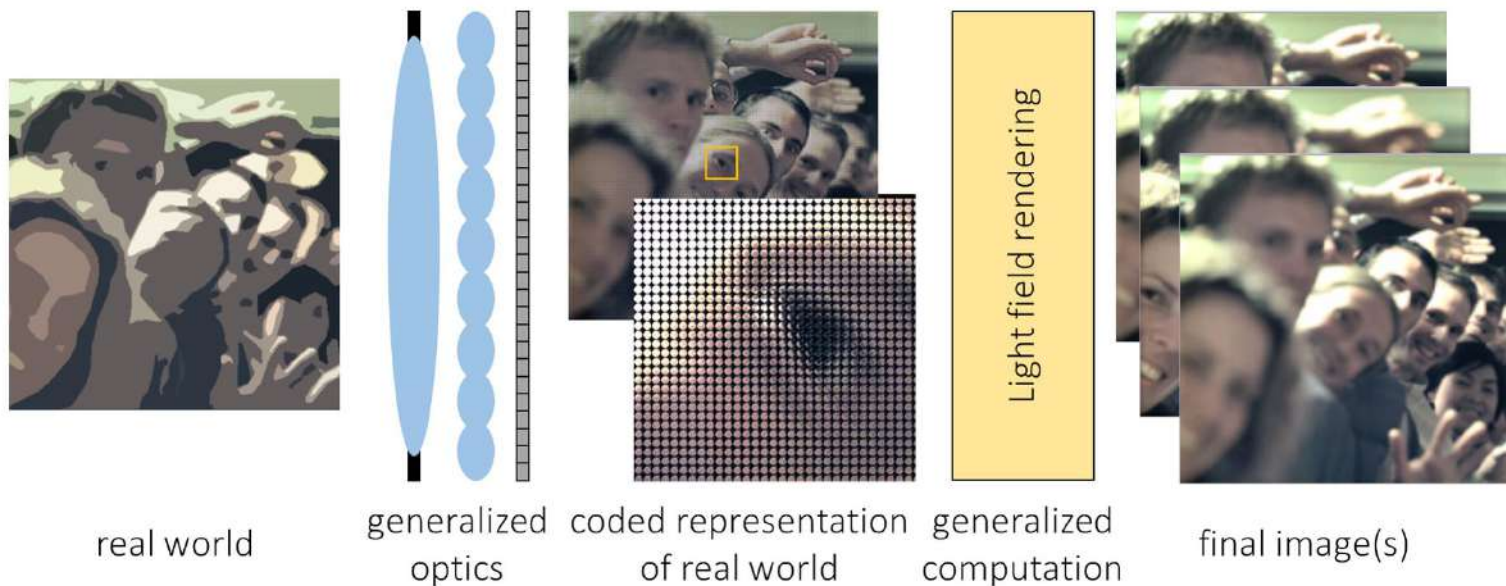
Light field photography

Option 3: use a plenoptic camera



Light field photography

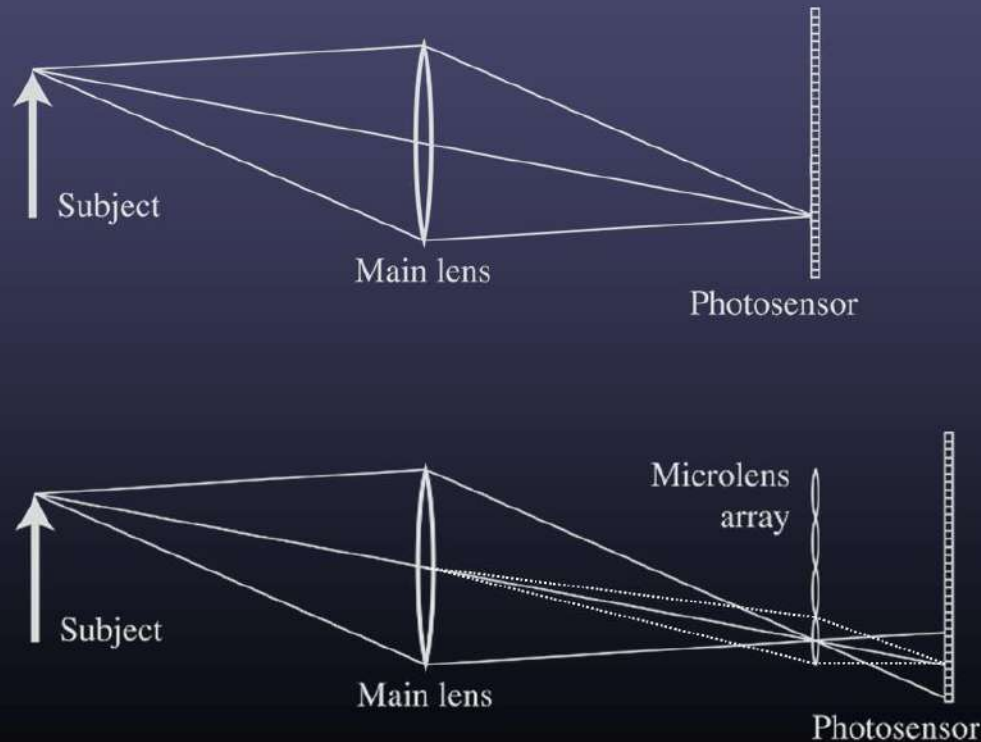
Option 3: use a plenoptic camera



- Plenoptic camera encodes world into light field.
- Light field rendering decodes light field into refocused or multi-viewpoint images.

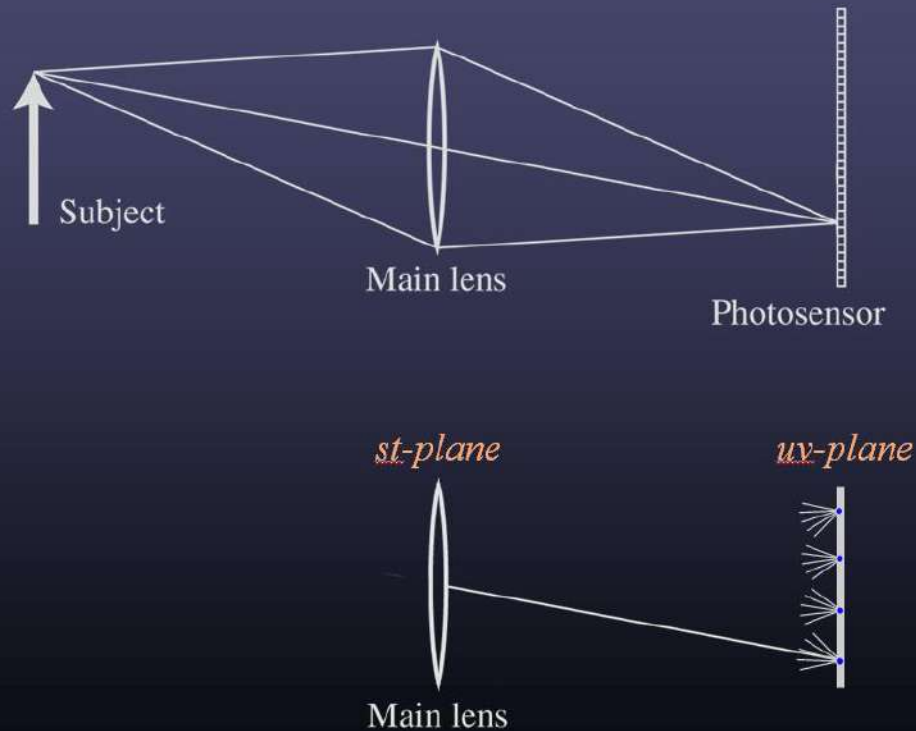
Light field photography

Conventional versus light field camera



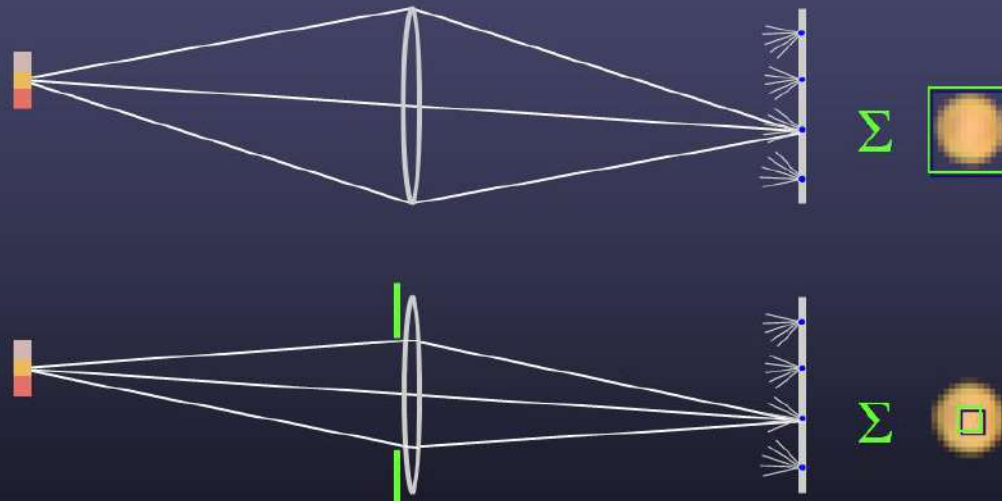
Light field photography

Conventional versus light field camera



Light field photography

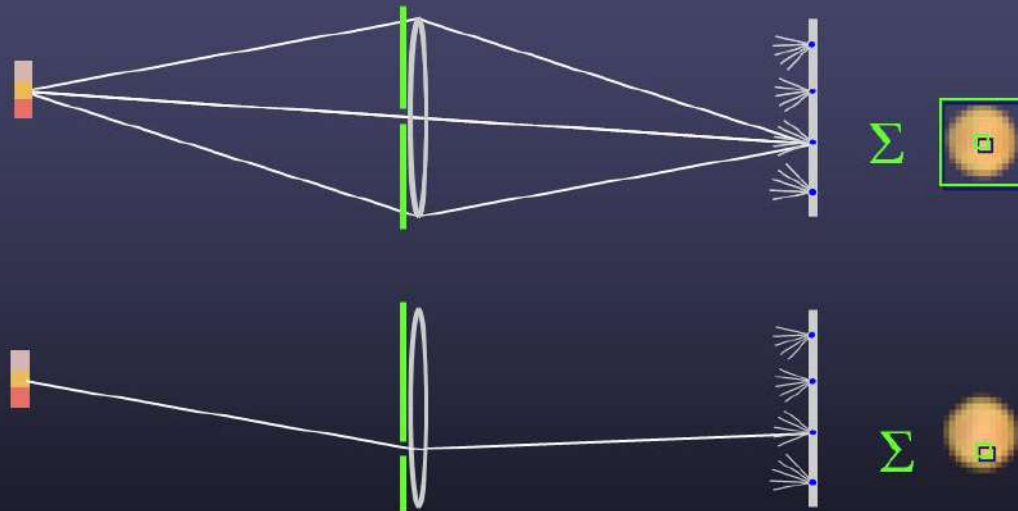
Digitally stopping-down the aperture



- stopping down = summing only the central portion of each microlens

Light field photography

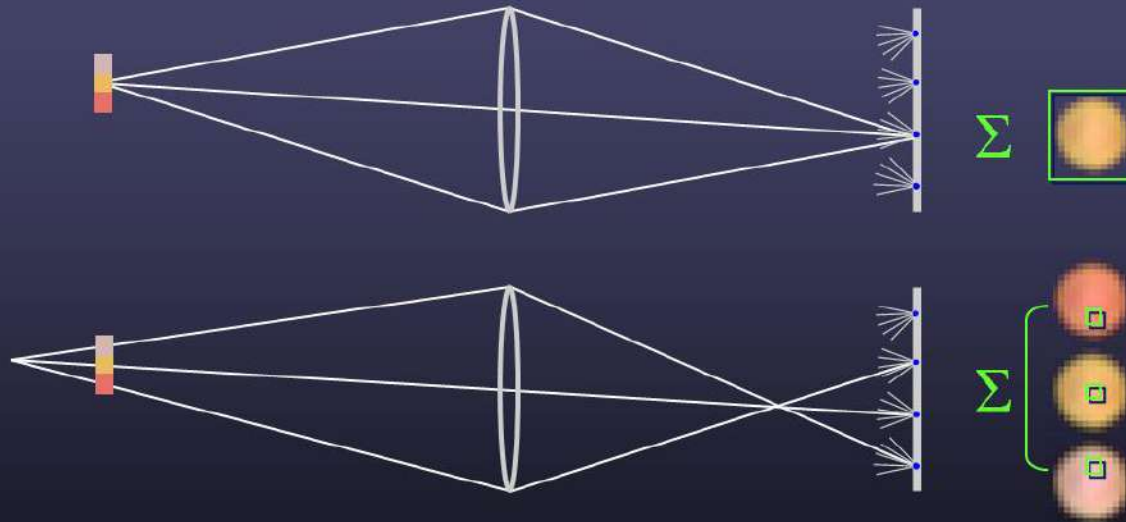
Digitally moving the observer



- moving the observer = moving the window we extract from the microlenses

Light field photography

Digital refocusing



- refocusing = summing windows extracted from several microlenses

Light field photography

Digital refocusing

refocusing



all focused



Light field photography

Light field photography using a handheld plenoptic camera



Lytro camera



Lytro Illum pro camera

Light field photography

What is Lytro camera?

- Plenoptic camera that has a main photographic lens, a micro-lens array and a digital photosensor
- Captures the light field of an image to replicate it with the ability to refocus the image afterwards



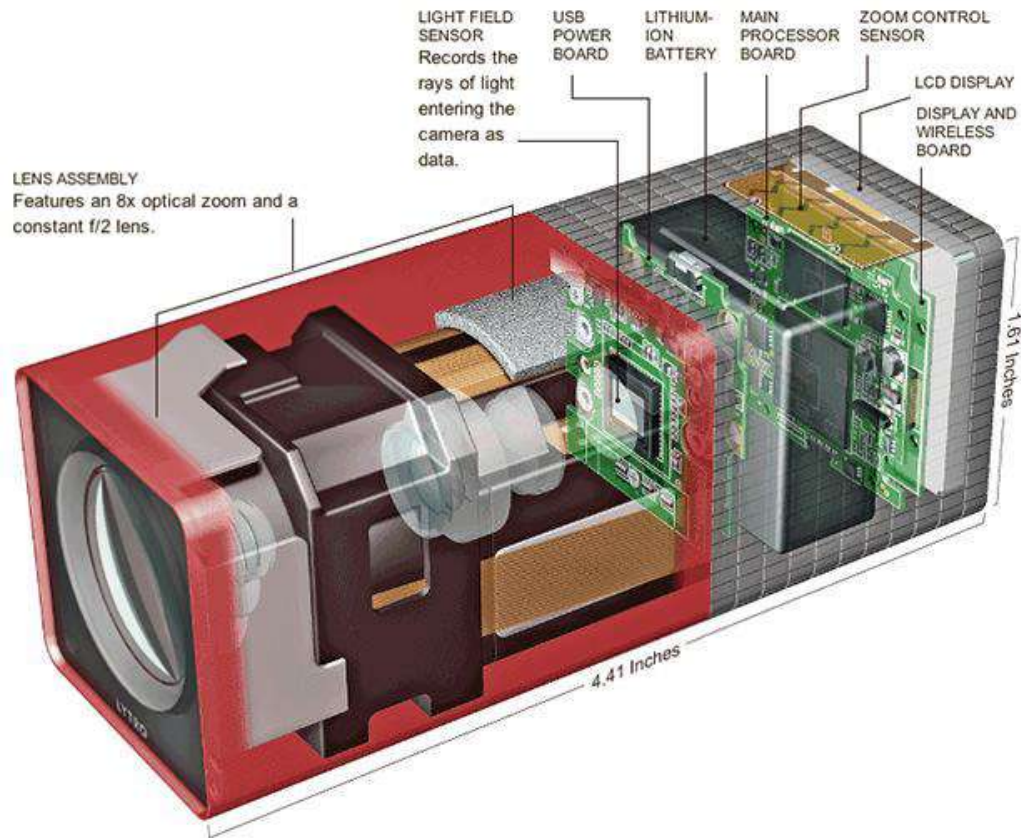
Light field photography

What is inside the Lytro Camera?

- Lens Array
- Light Field Sensor
- Light Field Engine
- Marvell Avastar 88W8787 SoC - a chip that offers WiFi and Bluetooth capabilities

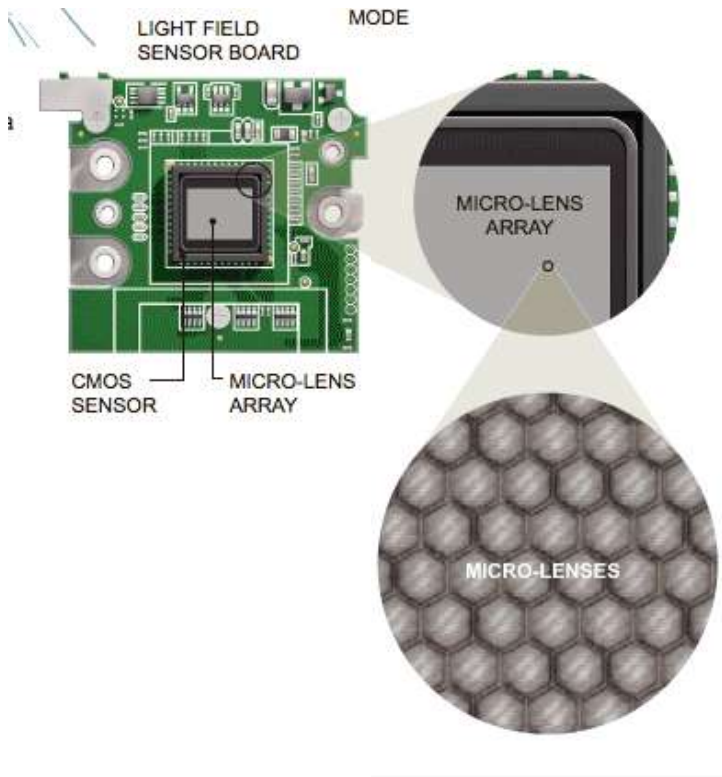
Light field photography

What is inside the Lytro Camera?



Light field photography

Light Field Sensor



- CMOS Sensor: common in cameras, convert light into electrons and place it into a cell. It then reads the values in each cell and changes it to a digital value.
- Micro-lens array: attached to a standard sensor, it divides the pixels from the CMOS into areas, showing the image at different angles.

Light field photography

Prototype camera



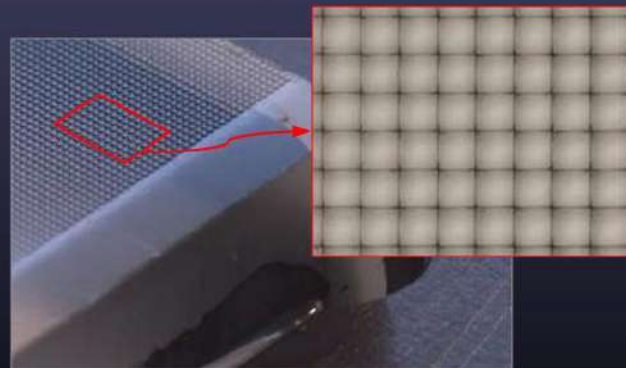
Contax medium format camera



Kodak 16-megapixel sensor



Adaptive Optics microlens array

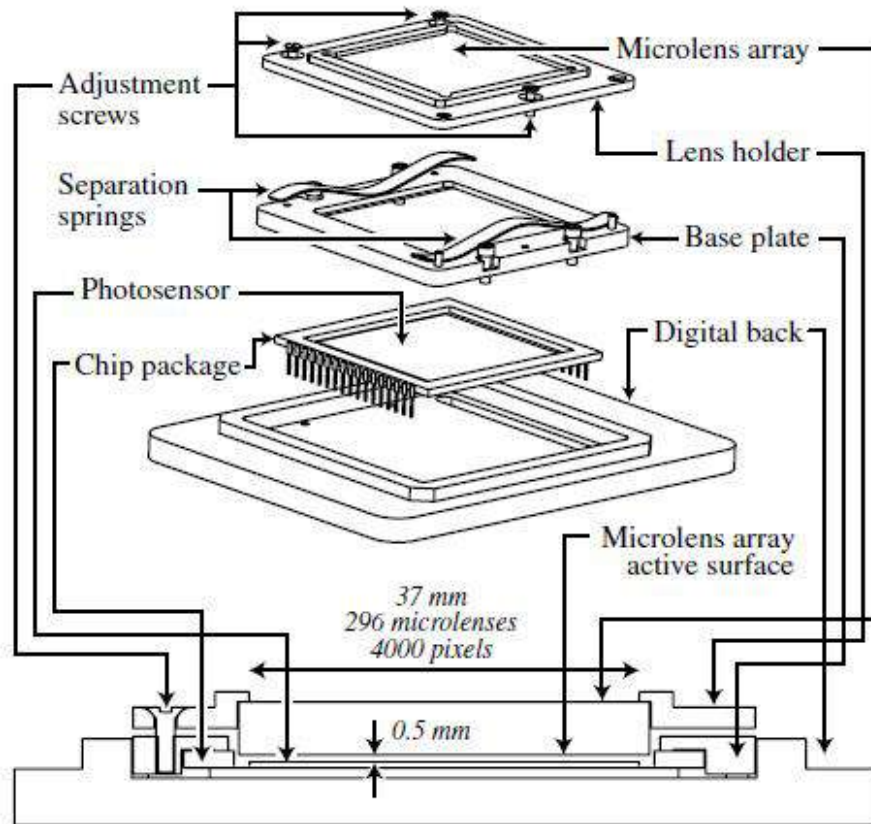


125μ square-sided microlenses

- $4000 \times 4000 \text{ pixels} \div 292 \times 292 \text{ lenses} = 14 \times 14 \text{ pixels per lens}$

Light field photography

Lytro camera specification



Light field photography

Industrial plenoptic cameras

Plenoptic cameras have become quite popular in lab and industrial settings.



- Much higher resolution, both spatial and angular, than commercial cameras.
- Support interchangeable lenses.
- Can do video.
- Very expensive.

Light field photography



Advantages

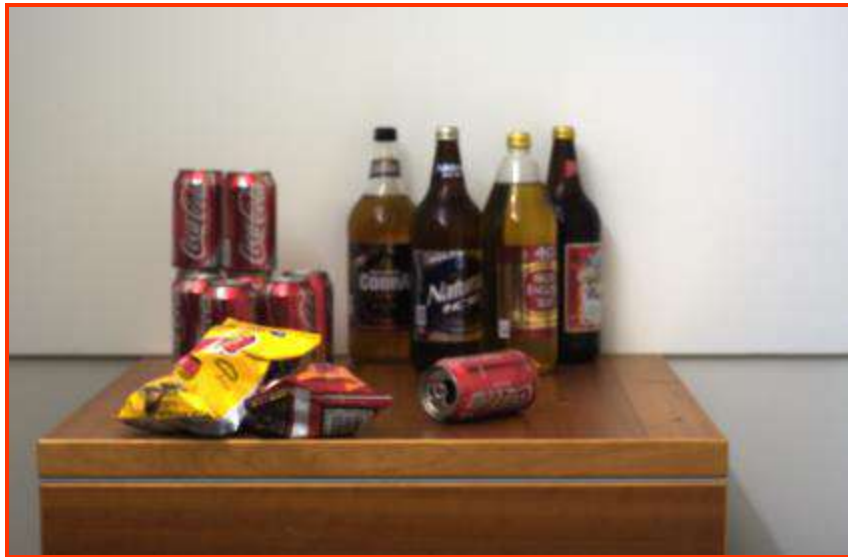
- highly portable
- refocusing ability

Disadvantages

- reduced total resolution
- fixed aperture

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Single input image

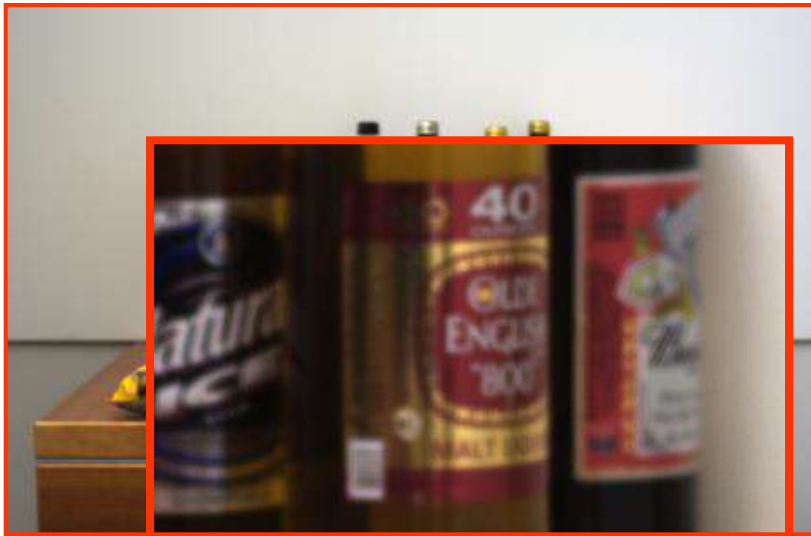


Output #1: Depth map



Conventional camera with coded aperture

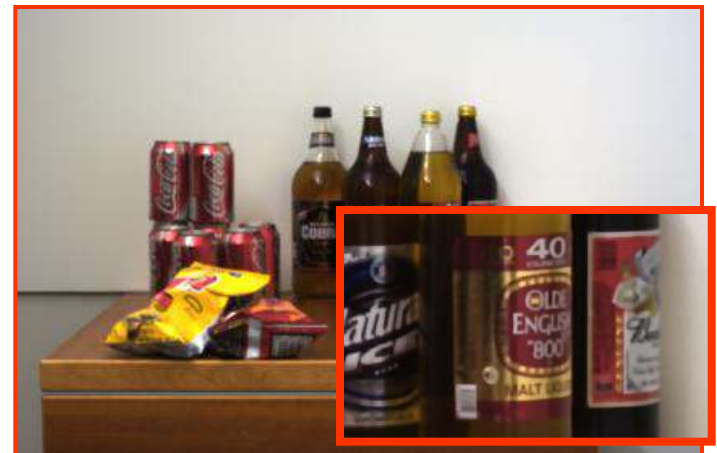
Single input image



Output #1: Depth map



Output #2: All-focused images



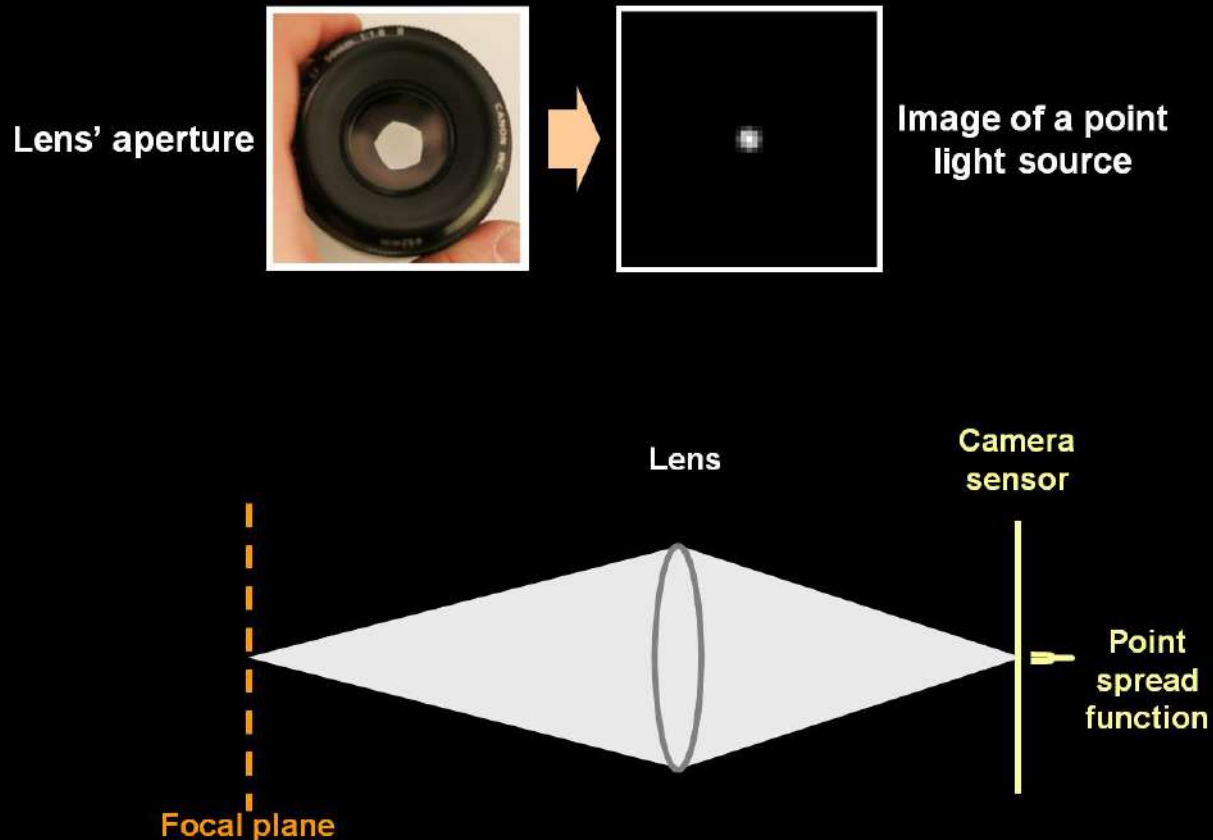
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Conventional camera vs. camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Lens and defocus



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Lens and defocus

Lens' aperture

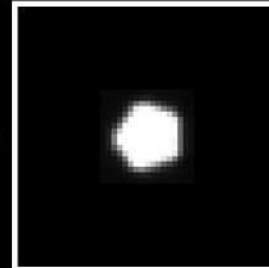


Image of a
defocused point
light source

Object

Lens

Camera
sensor

Focal plane

Point
spread
function

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Lens and defocus

Lens' aperture

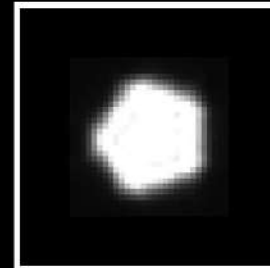


Image of a
defocused point
light source

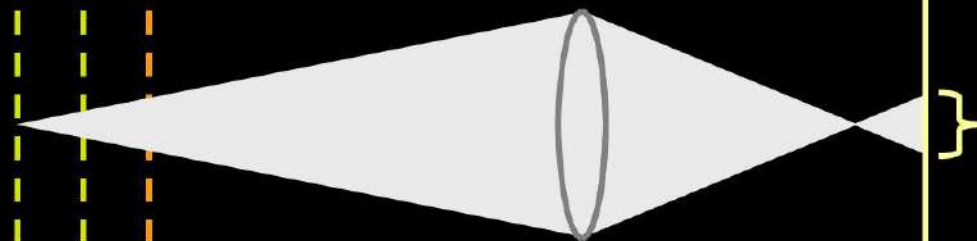
Object

Lens

Camera
sensor

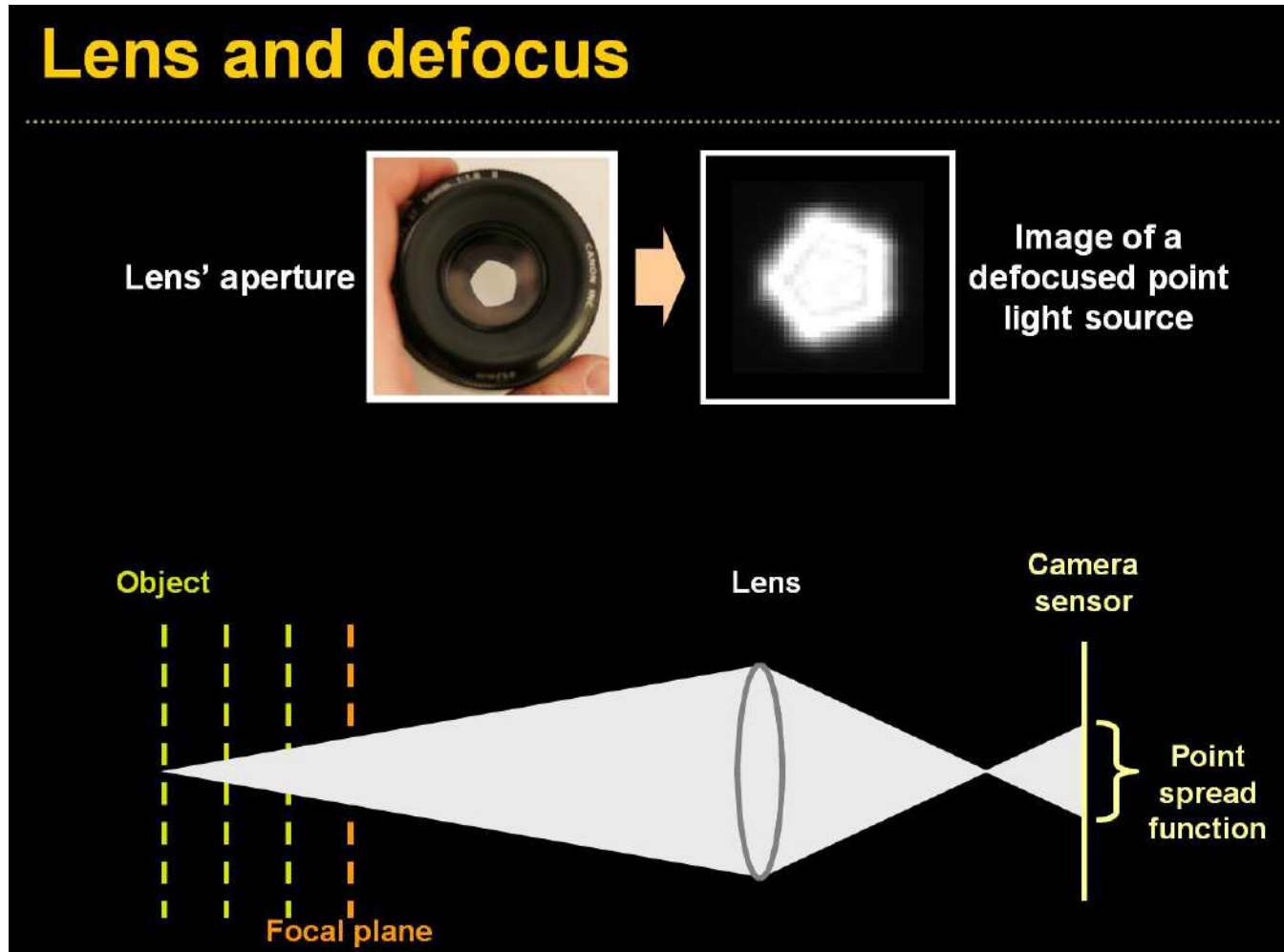


Focal plane



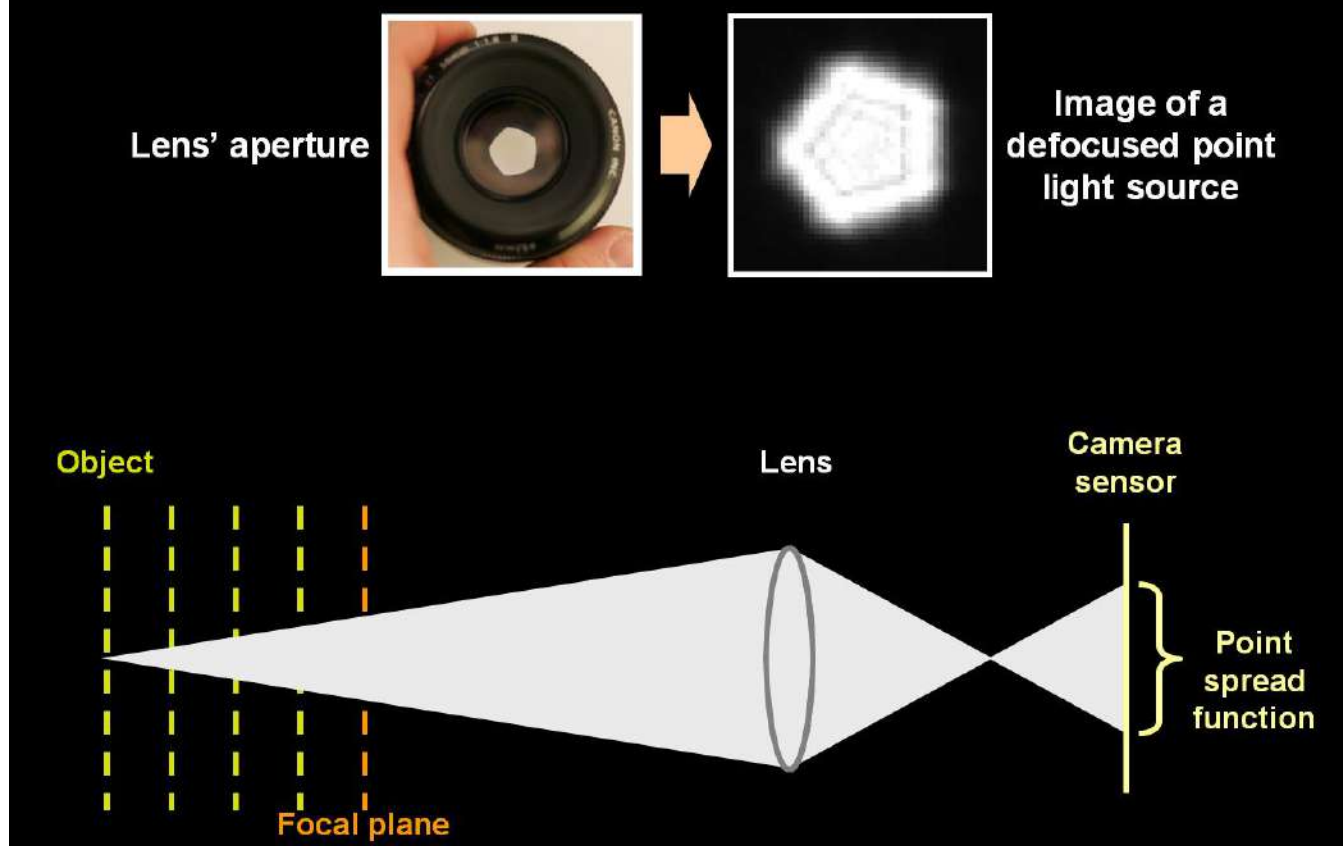
} Point
spread
function

Conventional camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Lens and defocus



Conventional camera with coded aperture



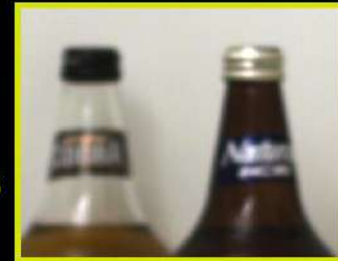
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Challenges

- Hard to discriminate a smooth scene from defocus blur

?

Out of focus



- Hard to undo defocus blur



Input



Ringings with conventional deblurring algorithm

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Possible solutions

- **Exploit prior on natural images**

- Improve deconvolution
- Improve depth discrimination



Natural



Unnatural

- **Coded aperture (mask inside lens)**

- make defocus patterns different from natural images and easier to discriminate

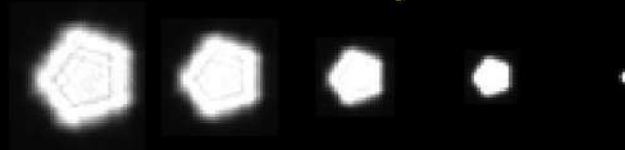


Conventional camera with coded aperture

Defocus as local convolution



Calibrated blur kernels at different depths



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Defocus as local convolution



$$y' = f_k \otimes x$$

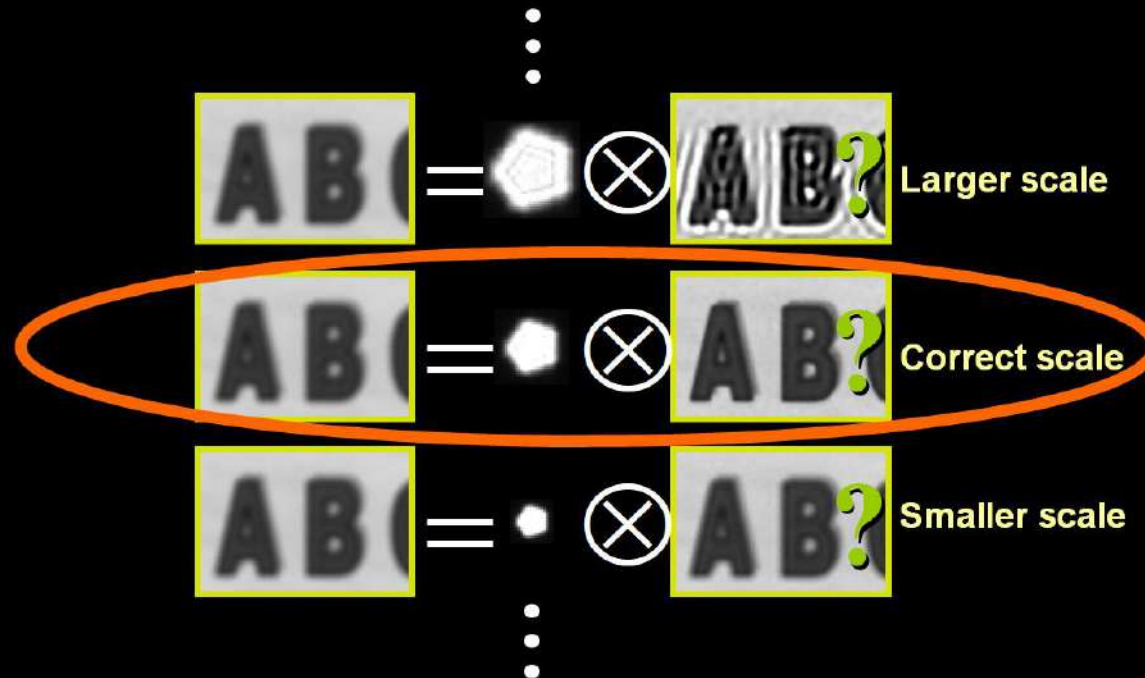
Local sub-window Calibrated blur kernels at depth k Sharp sub-window



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Overview

Try deconvolving local input windows with different scaled filters:



Somehow: select best scale.

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Challenges

- Hard to deconvolve even when kernel is known

Input   

Ringing with the traditional Richardson-Lucy deconvolution algorithm

- Hard to identify correct scale:

?		=		$\otimes$		Larger scale
?		=		$\otimes$		Correct scale
?		=		$\otimes$		Smaller scale

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Deconvolution is ill posed

$$f \otimes x = y$$

Solution 1:



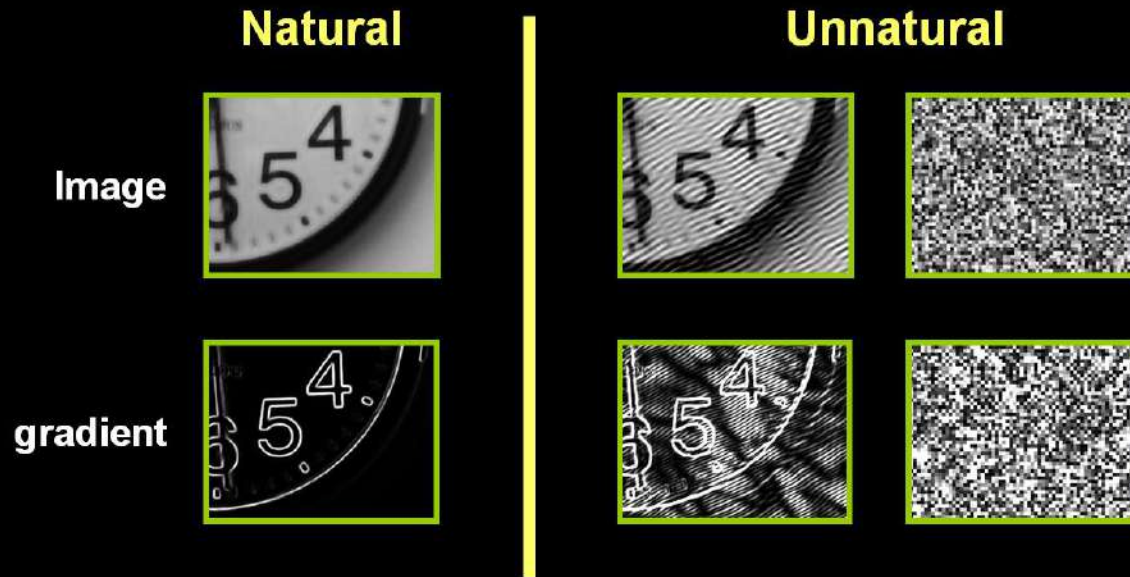
Solution 2:



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Idea 1: Natural images prior

What makes images special?



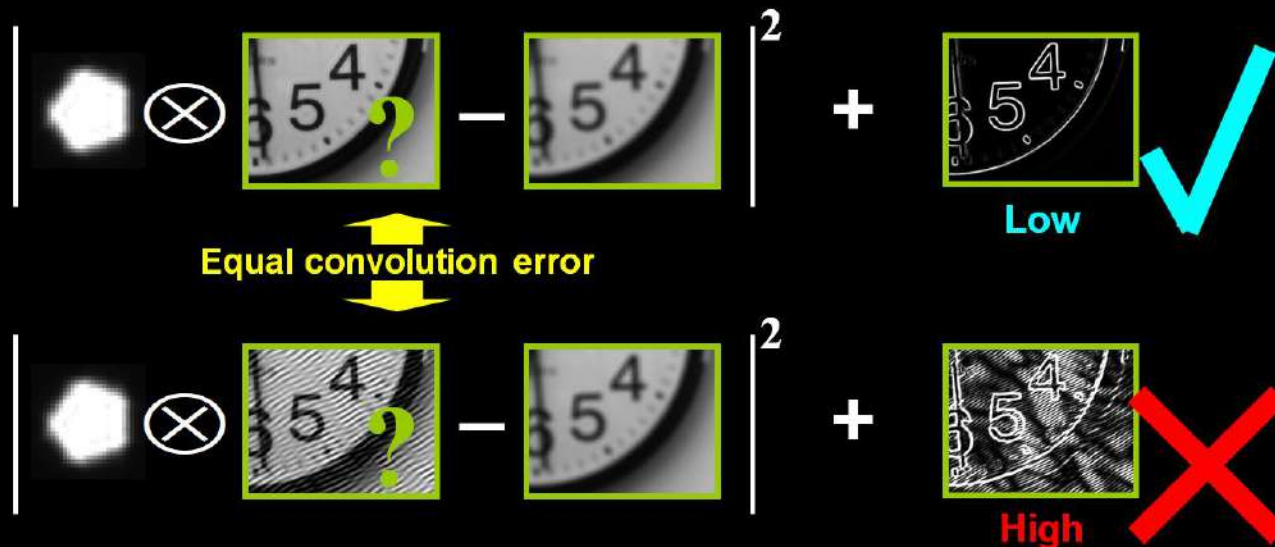
Natural images have sparse gradients

➡ put a penalty on gradients

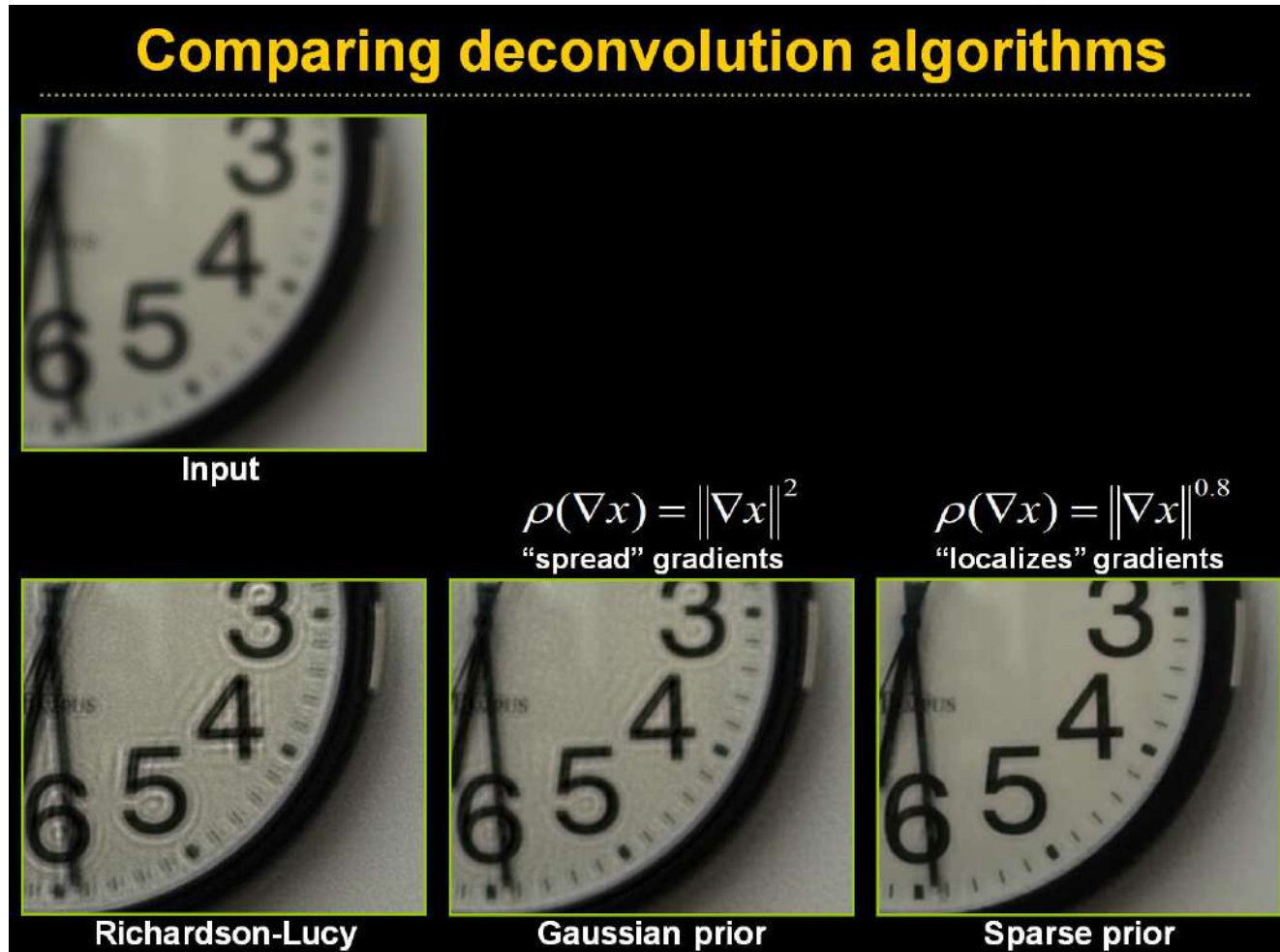
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Deconvolution with prior

$$x = \arg \min \underbrace{|f \otimes x - y|^2}_{\text{Convolution error}} + \lambda \underbrace{\sum_i \rho(\nabla x_i)}_{\text{Derivatives prior}}$$



Conventional camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Comparing deconvolution algorithms

Input

$\rho(\nabla x) = \|\nabla x\|^2$
“spread” gradients

$\rho(\nabla x) = \|\nabla x\|^{0.8}$
“localizes” gradients

Richardson-Lucy

Gaussian prior

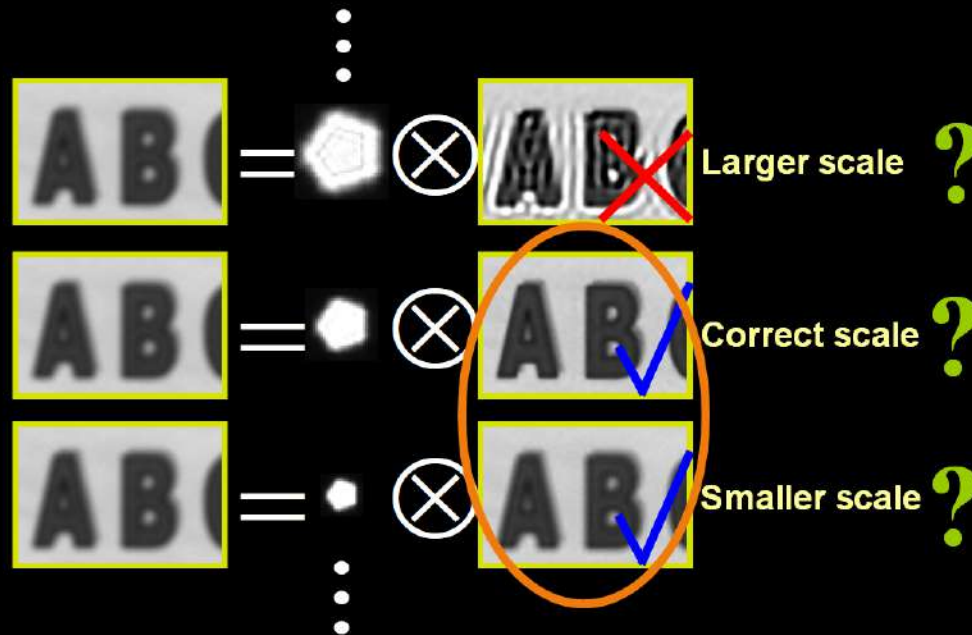
Sparse prior



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Recall: Overview

Try deconvolving local input windows with different scaled filters:



Somehow: select best scale.

Challenge: smaller scale not so different than correct

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Idea 2: Coded Aperture

- **Mask (code) in aperture plane**
 - make defocus patterns different from natural images and easier to discriminate



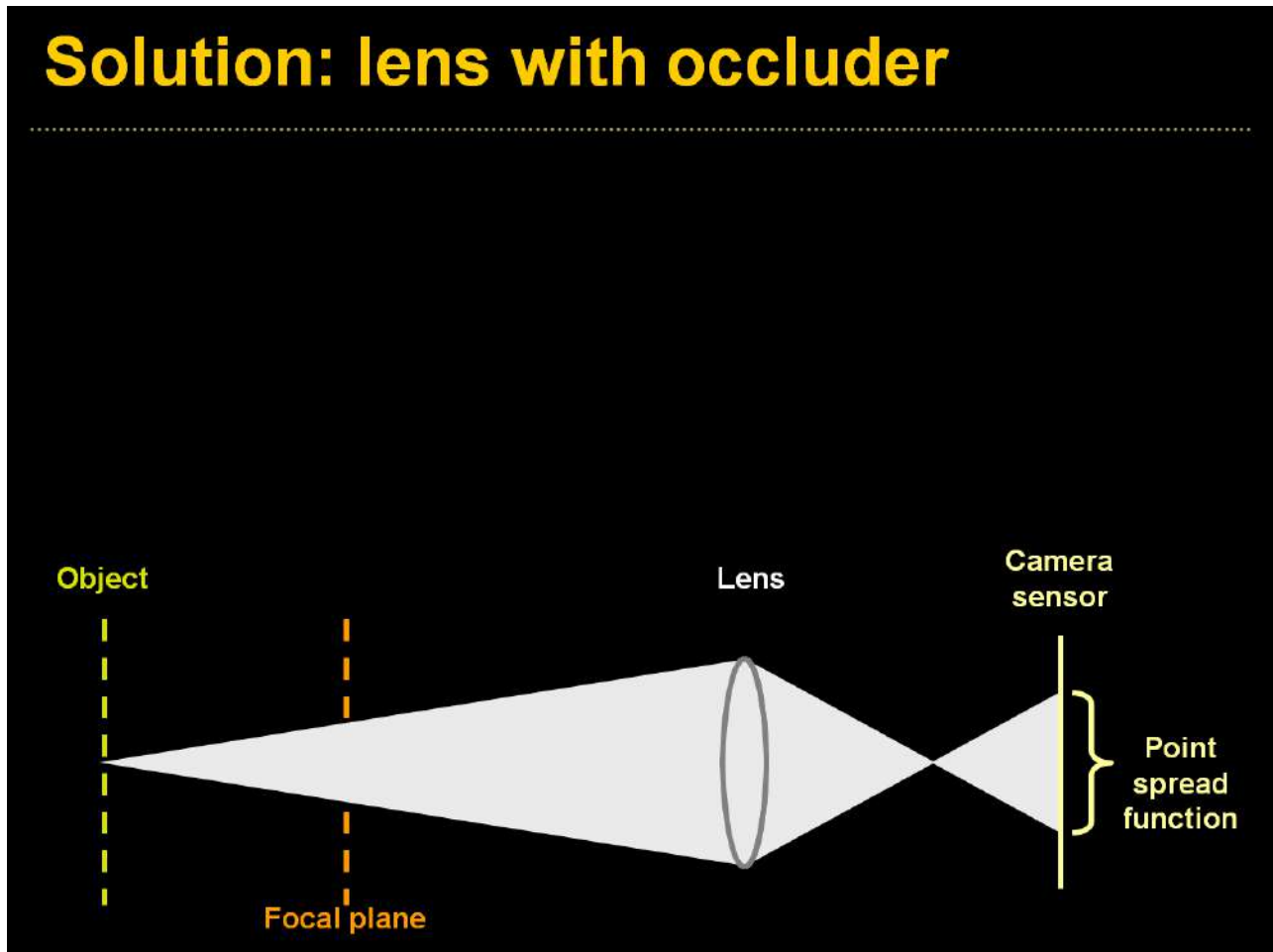
**Conventional
aperture**



**Coded
aperture**

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Solution: lens with occluder



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Solution: lens with occluder

Aperture pattern

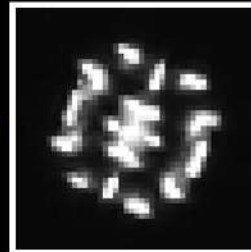
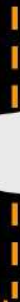


Image of a
defocused point
light source

Object



Focal plane



Lens with coded
aperture



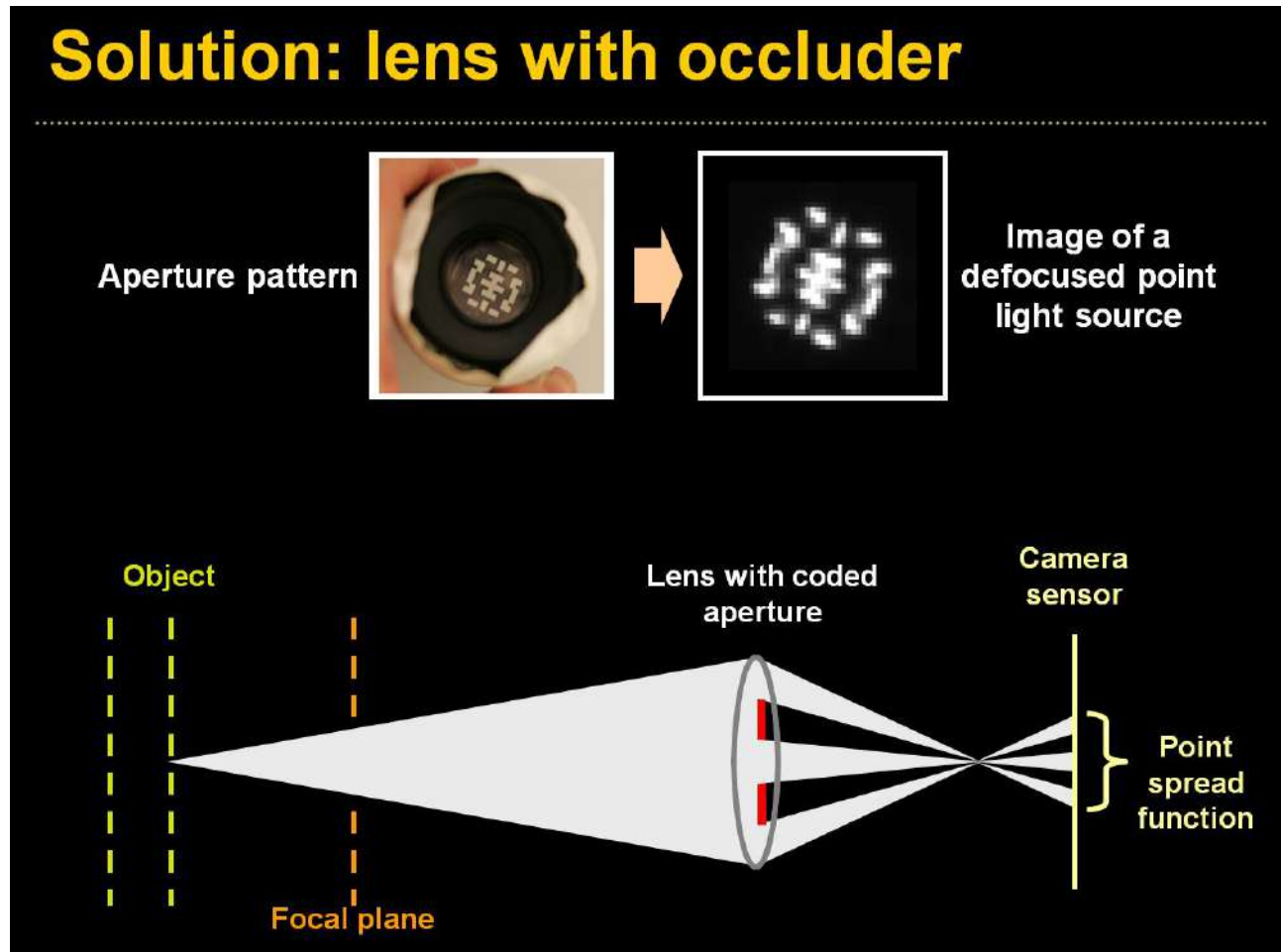
Camera
sensor



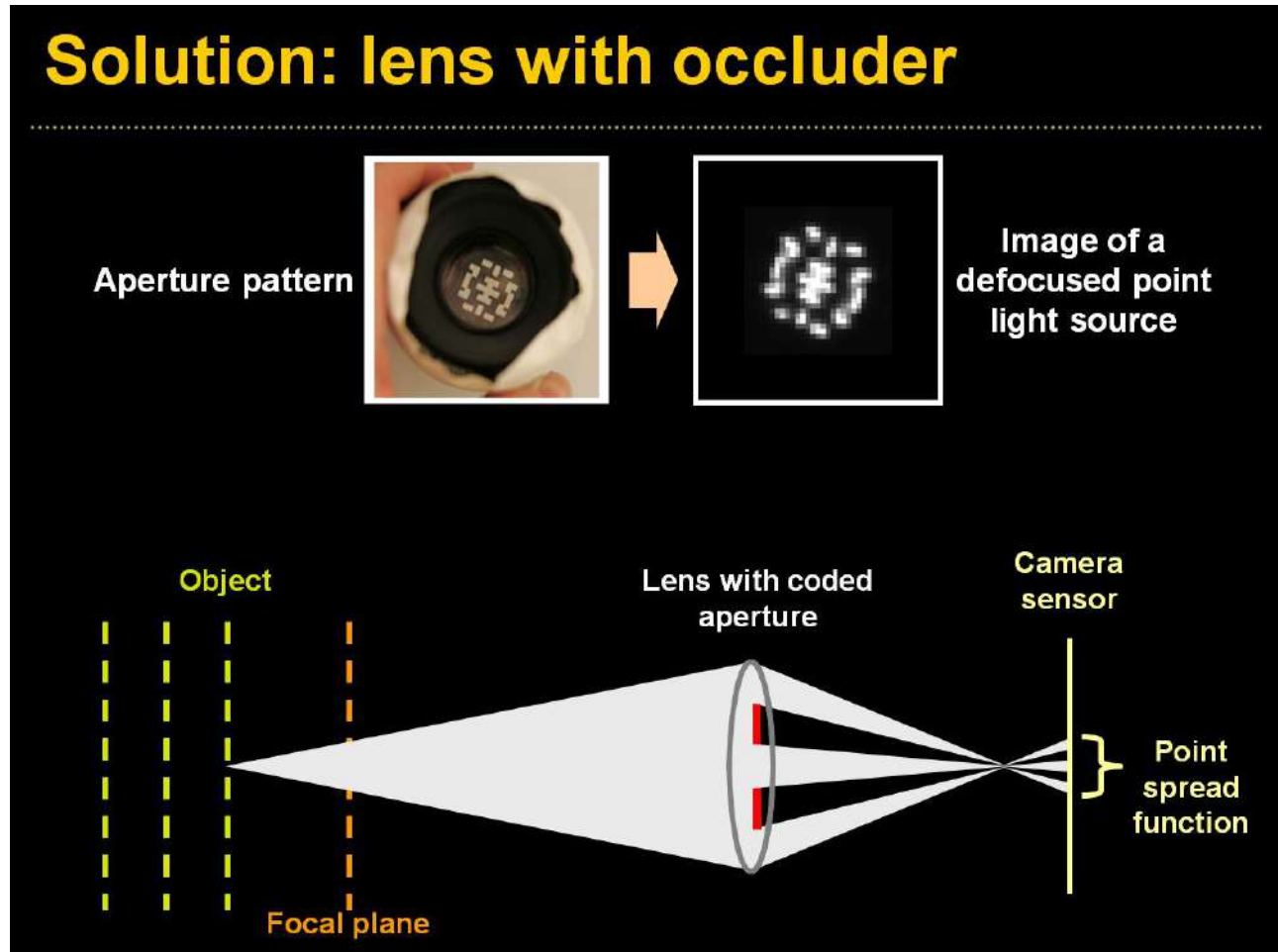
Point
spread
function



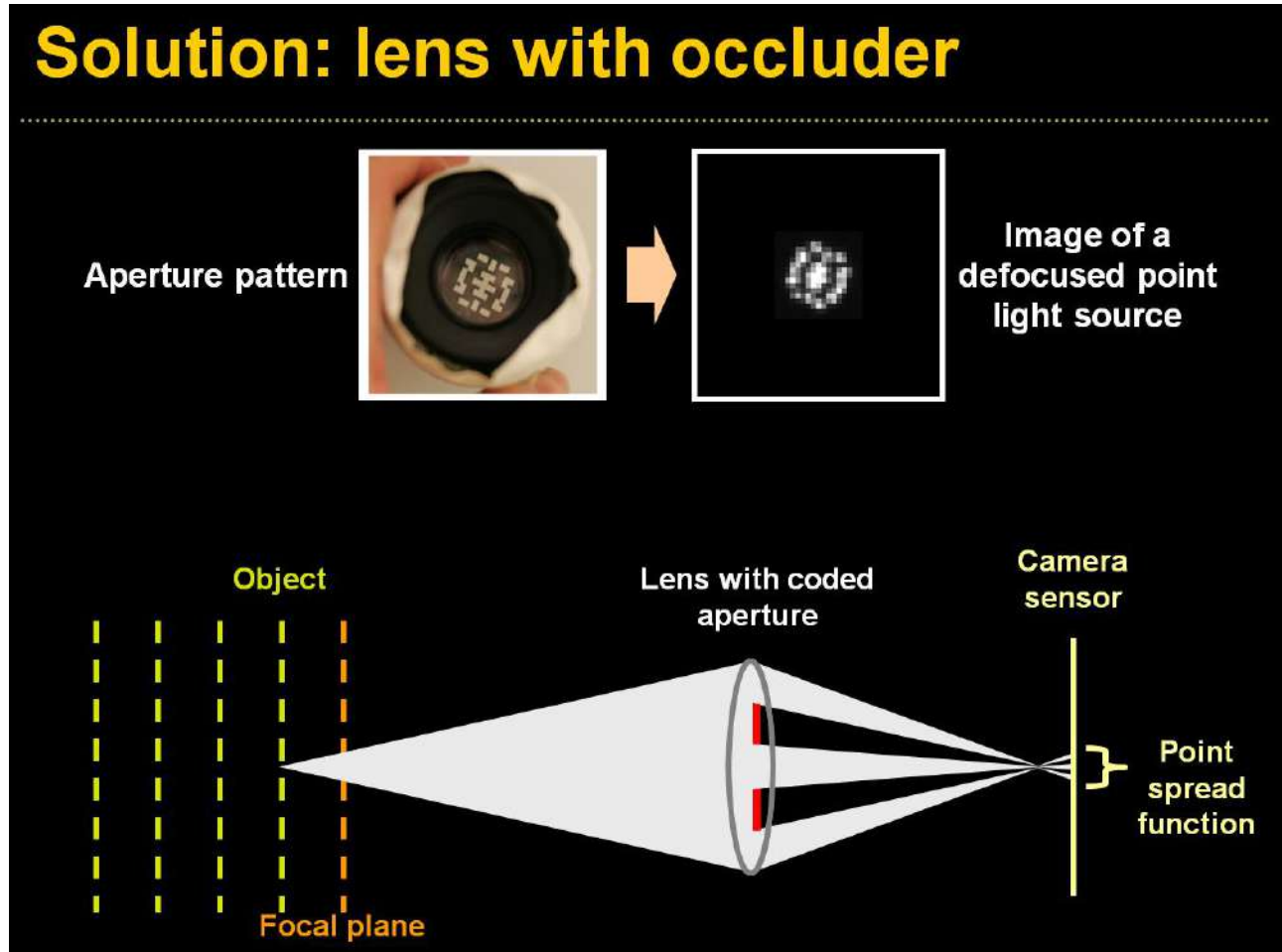
Conventional camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture

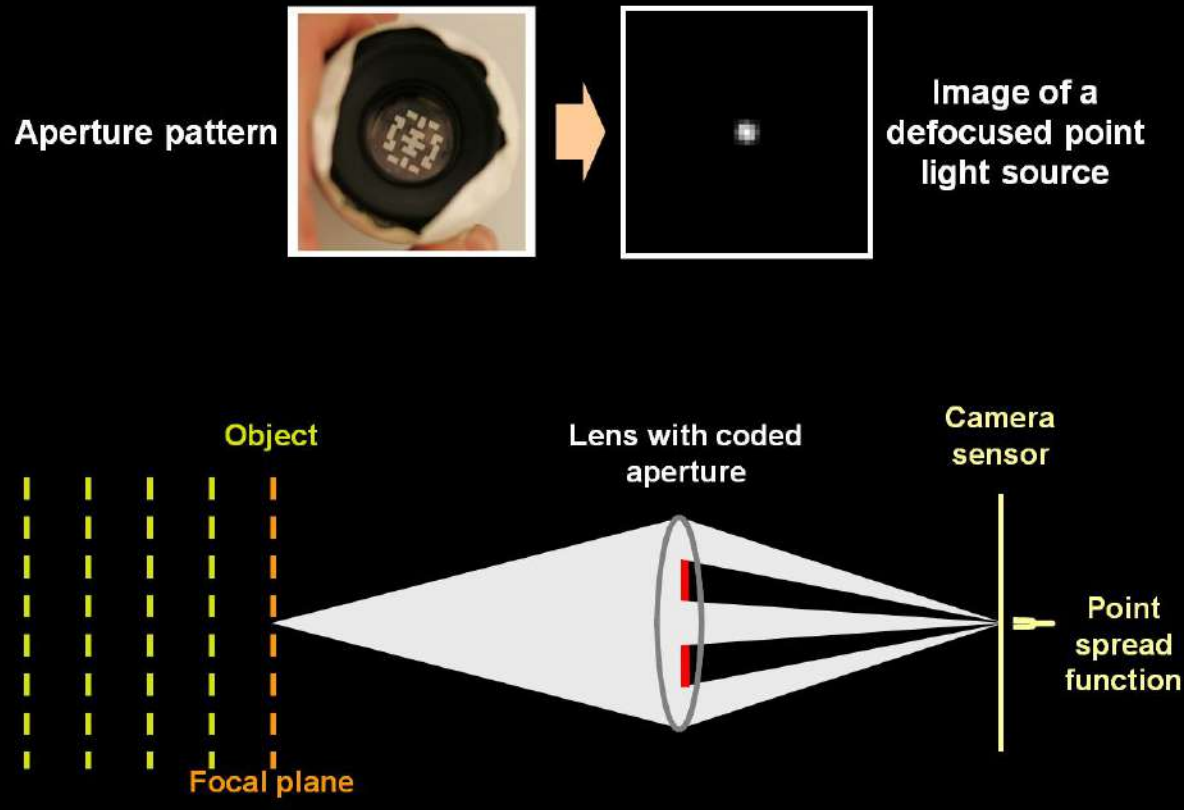


Conventional camera with coded aperture

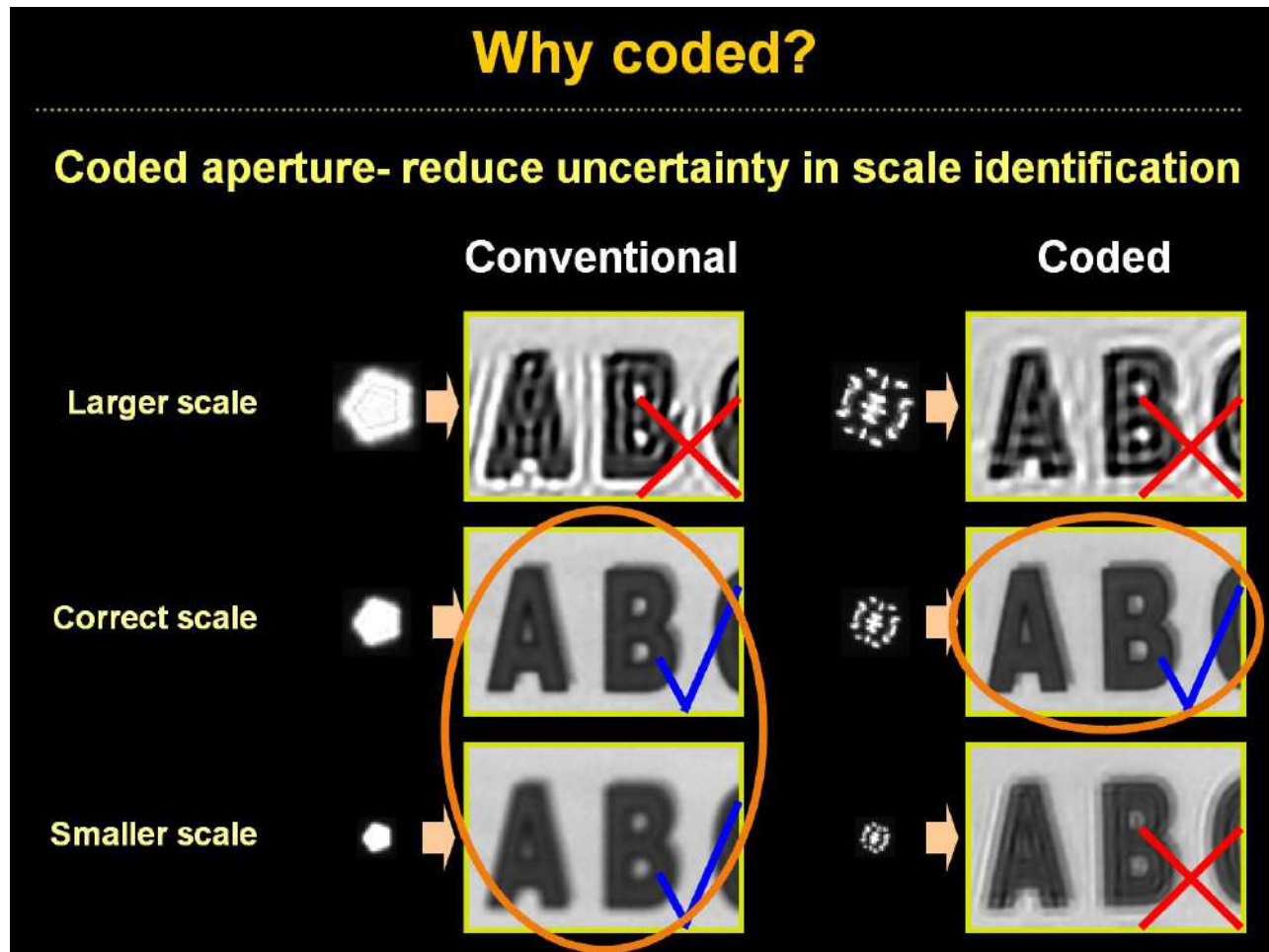


Conventional camera with coded aperture

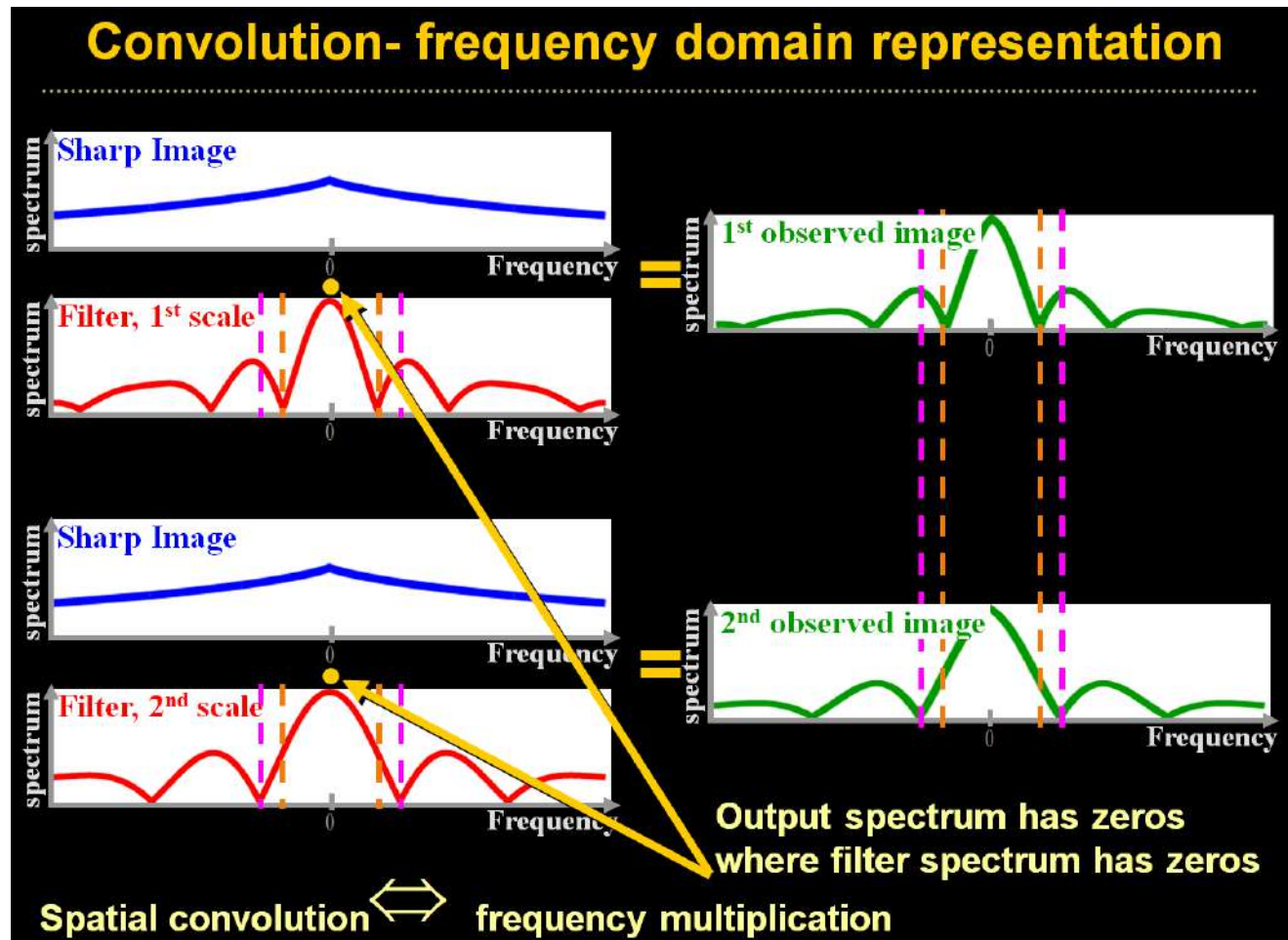
Solution: lens with occluder



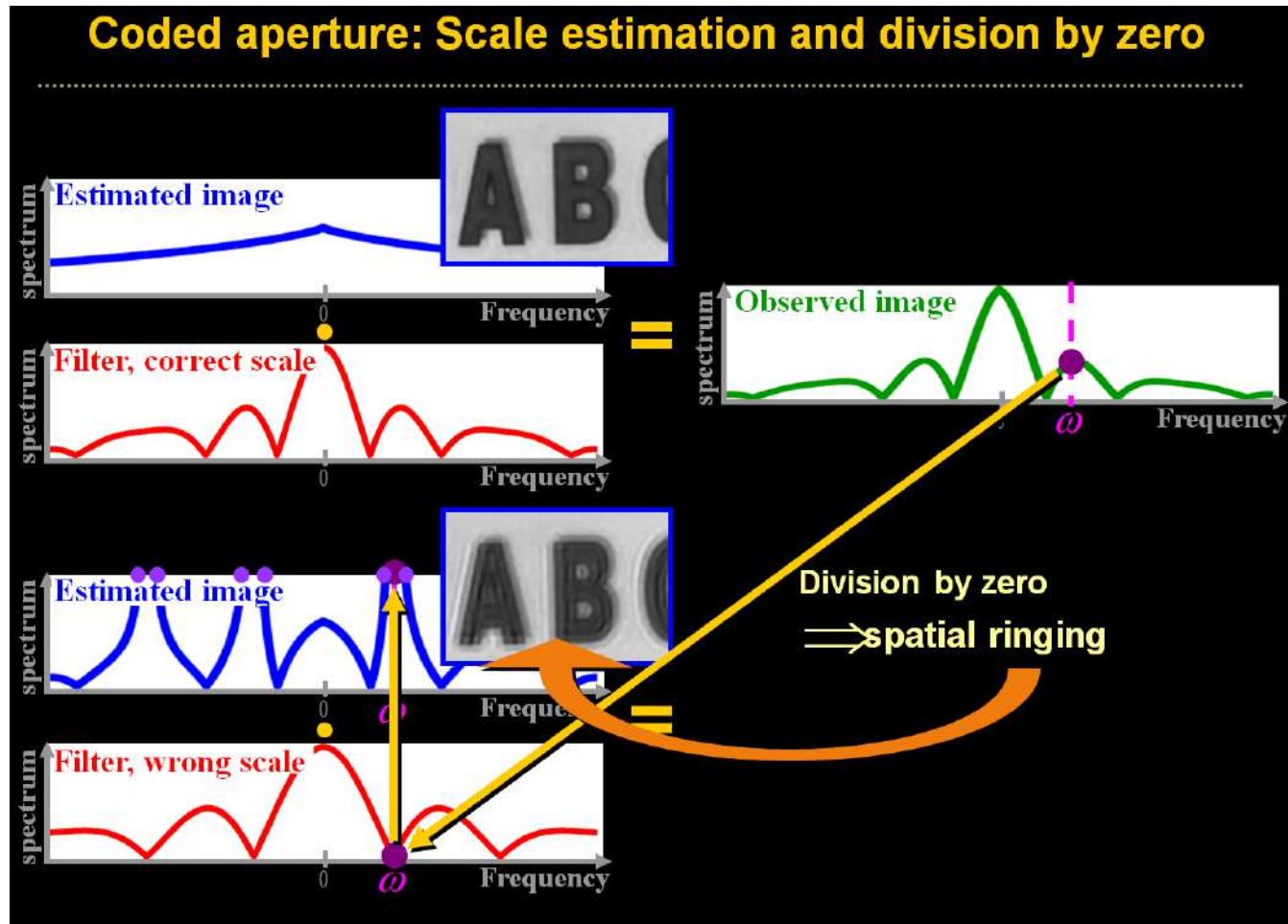
Conventional camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture

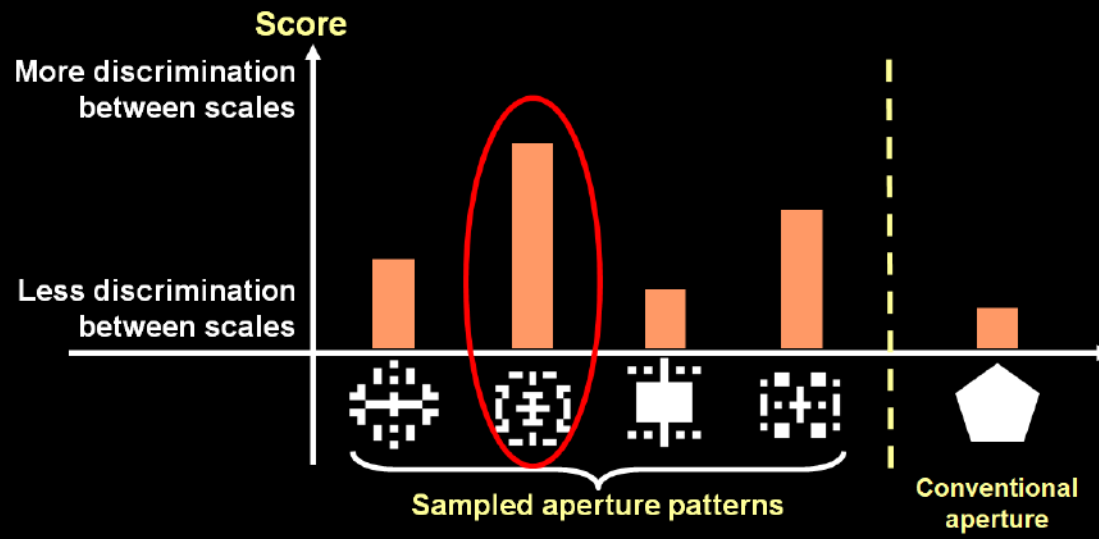


Conventional camera with coded aperture

Filter Design

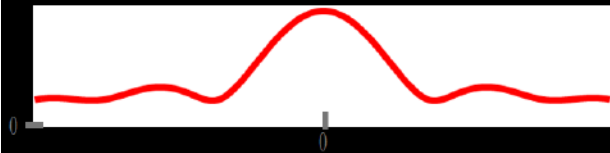
Analytically search for a pattern maximizing discrimination between images at different defocus scales (*KL-divergence*)

Account for image prior and physical constraints



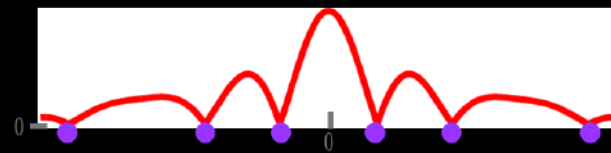
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Zero frequencies- pros and cons



No zero frequencies:

- + Filter can be easily inverted
- Weaker depth discrimination



Include zero frequencies:

- + Zeros improve depth discrimination
- Inversion difficult
- + Inversion made possible with image priors

Conventional camera with coded aperture

Regularizing depth estimation

Try deblurring with 10 different aperture scales

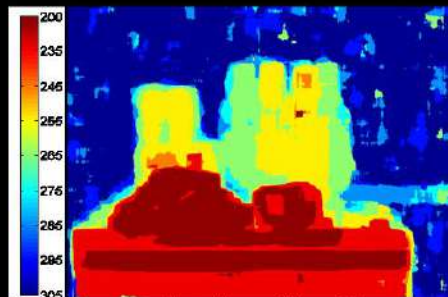
$$x = \arg \min \underbrace{|f \otimes x - y|^2}_{\text{Convolution error}} + \underbrace{\lambda \sum_i \rho(\nabla x_i)}_{\text{Derivatives prior}}$$

$$\left| \begin{array}{c} \text{Coded aperture} \\ \otimes \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{Image} \\ \text{5}^4 \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{Image} \\ \text{5}^4 \end{array} \right|^2 + \begin{array}{c} \text{Image} \\ \text{5}^4 \end{array}$$

Keep minimal error scale in each local window + regularization



Input

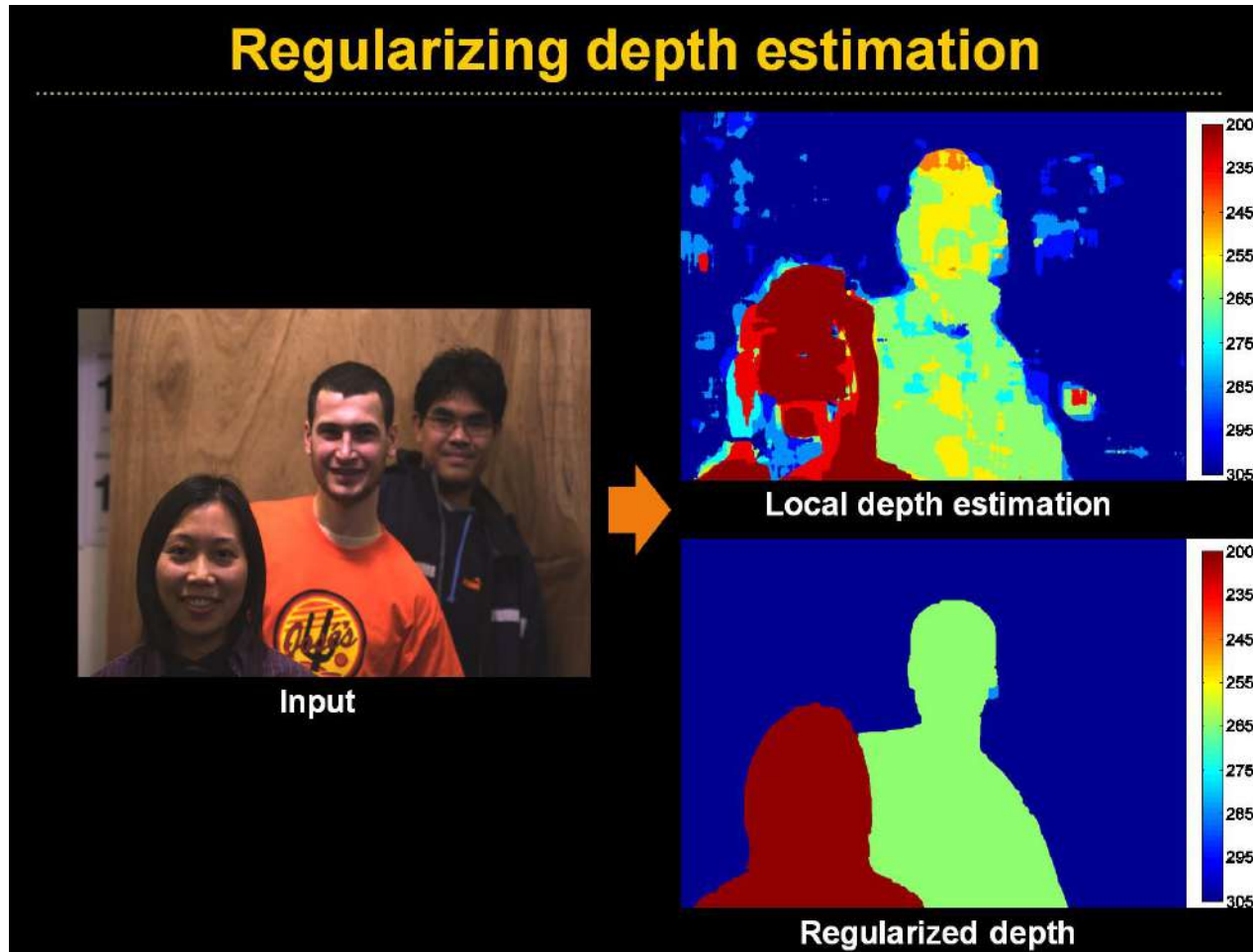


Local depth estimation



Regularized depth

Conventional camera with coded aperture



Conventional camera with coded aperture

All focused results



Conventional camera with coded aperture

All focused results

All-focused
(deconvolved)



Conventional camera with coded aperture

All focused results

Close-up

Original image



All-focus image



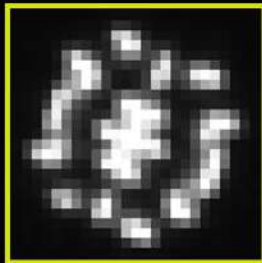
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Comparison- conventional aperture result



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Comparison- coded aperture result



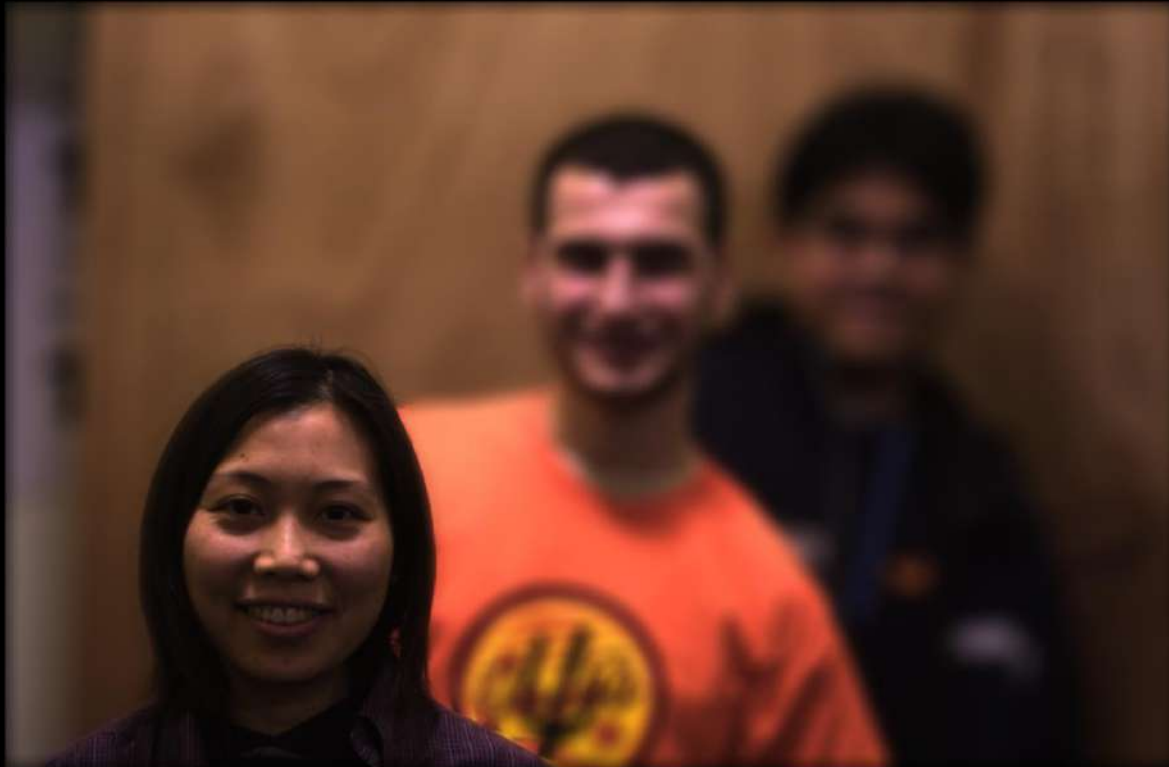
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Digital refocusing from a single image



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Digital refocusing from a single image



Conventional camera with coded aperture

Digital refocusing from a single image

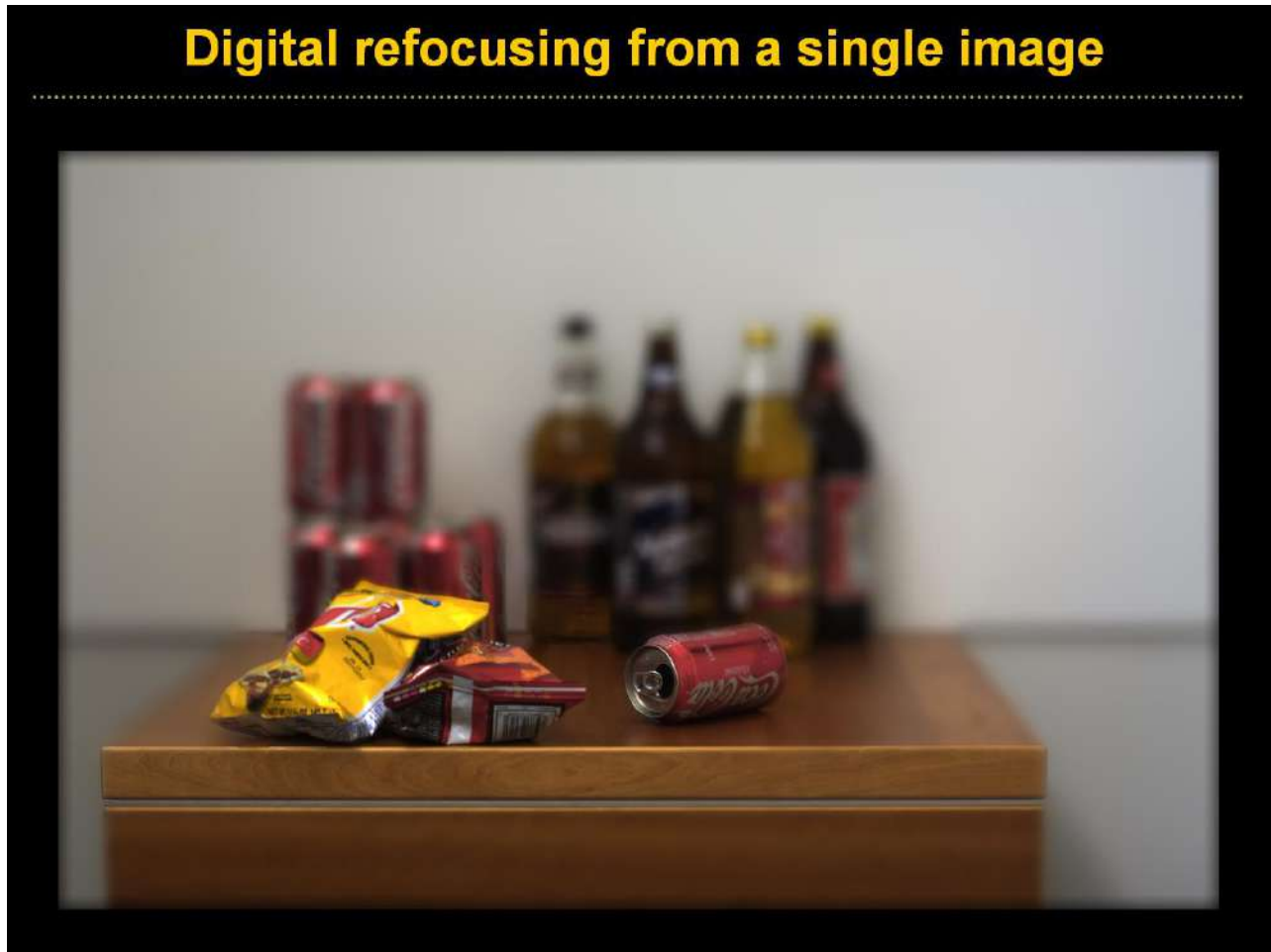


Conventional camera with coded aperture

Digital refocusing from a single image

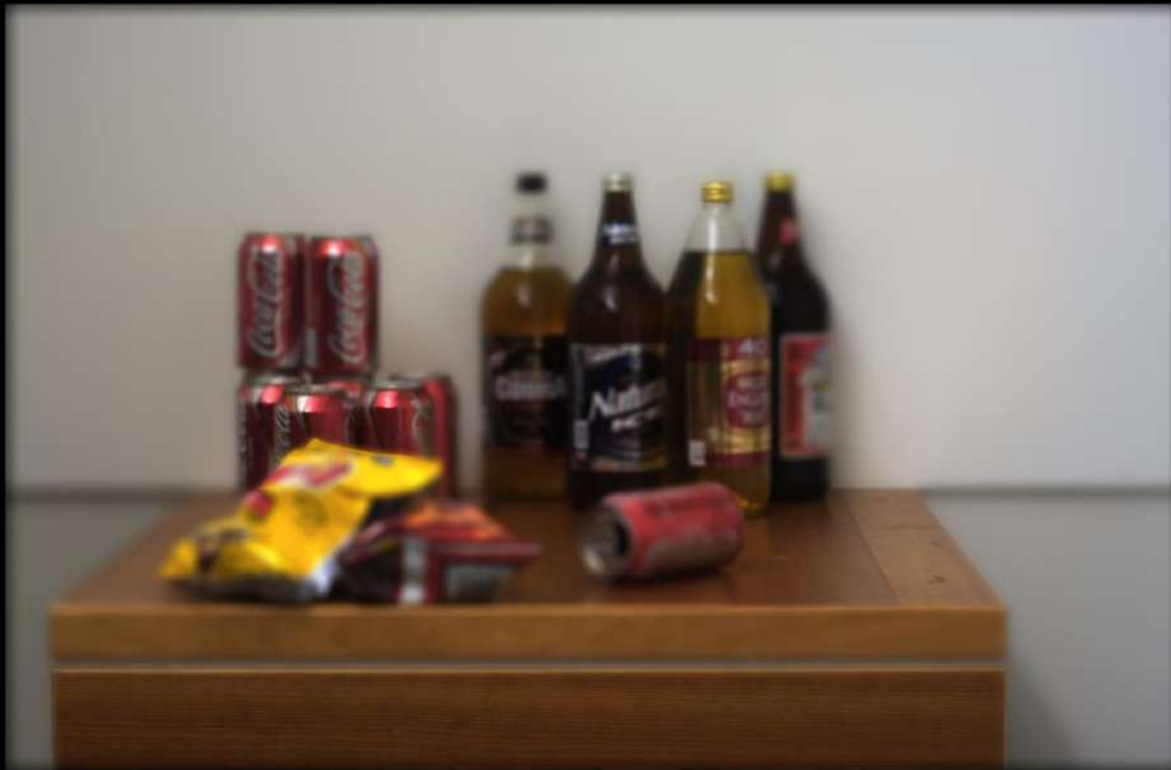


Conventional camera with coded aperture



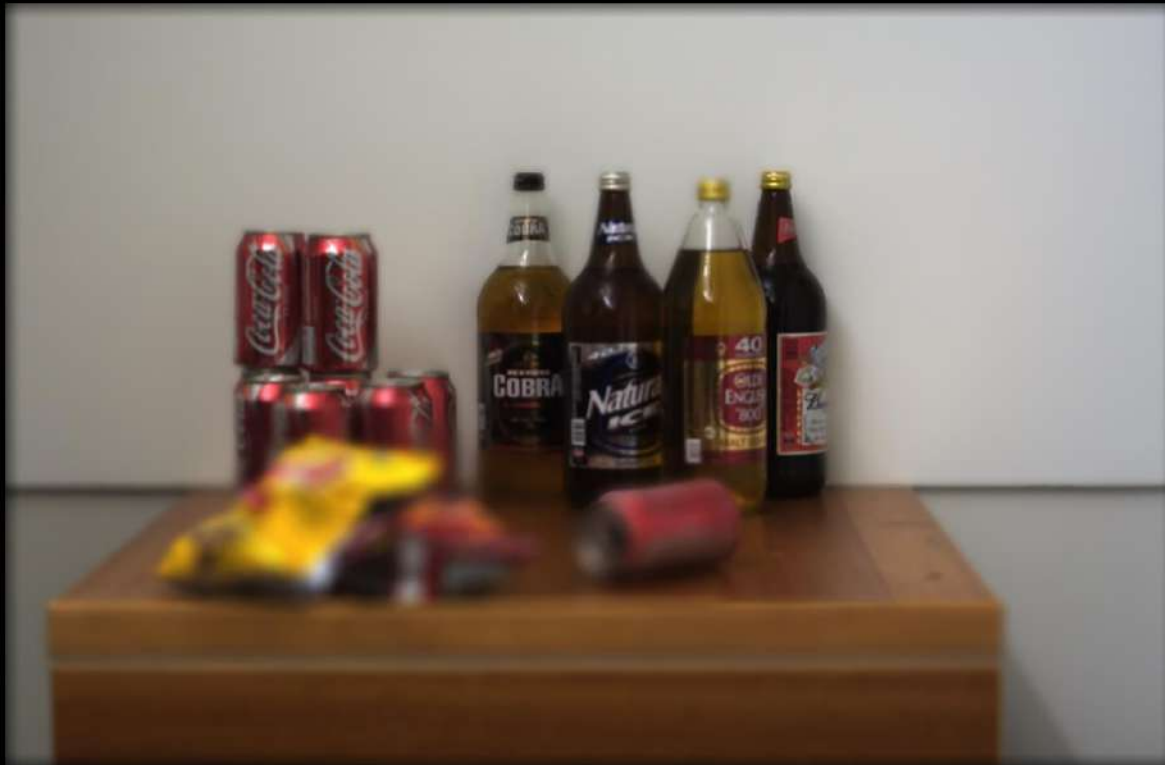
Conventional camera with coded aperture

Digital refocusing from a single image



Conventional camera with coded aperture

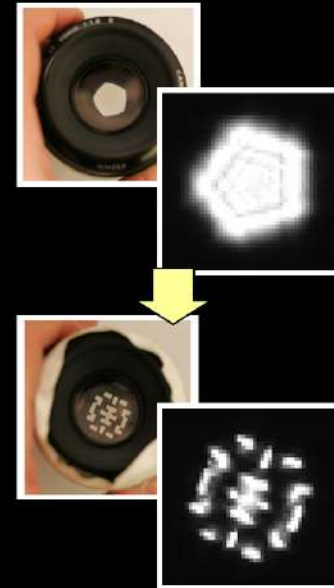
Digital refocusing from a single image



Conventional camera with coded aperture

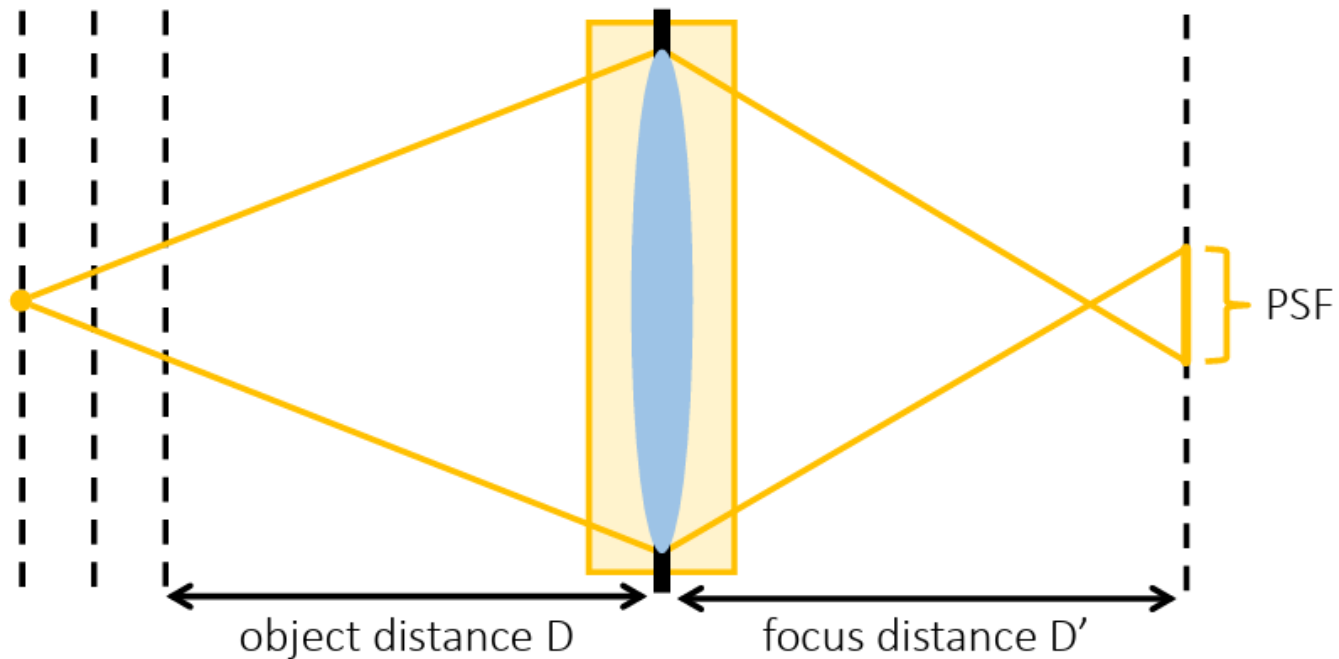
Coded aperture: pros and cons

- + Image AND depth at a single shot
- + No loss of image resolution
- + Simple modification to lens
- Depth is coarse
unable to get depth at untextured areas,
might need manual corrections.
- + But depth is a pure bonus
- Loss some light
- + But deconvolution increases depth of field



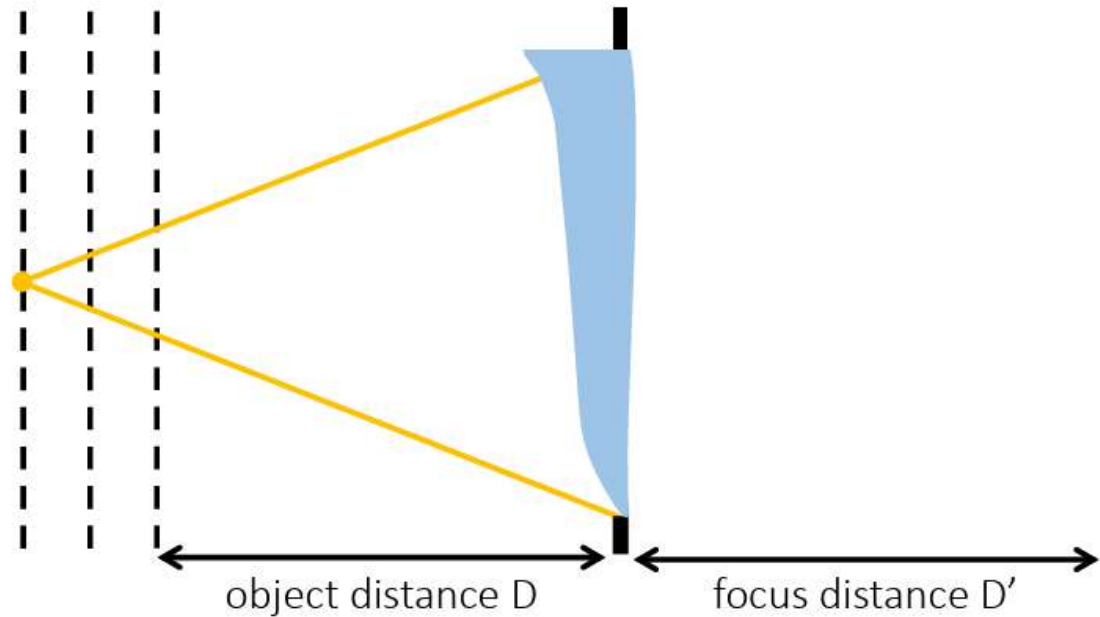
Camera with generalized optics

Change optics, not aperture



Camera with generalized optics

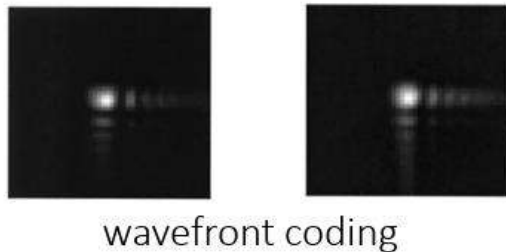
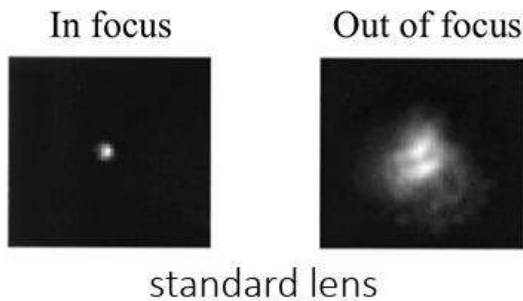
Wavefront coding



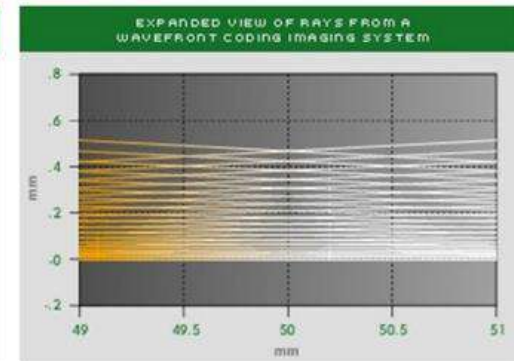
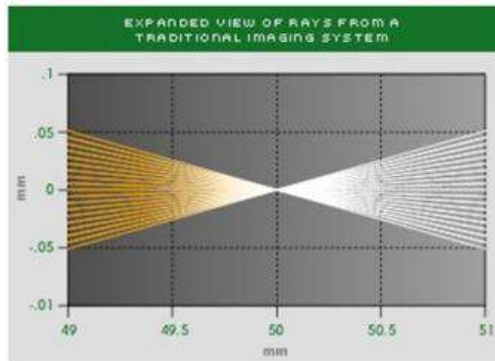
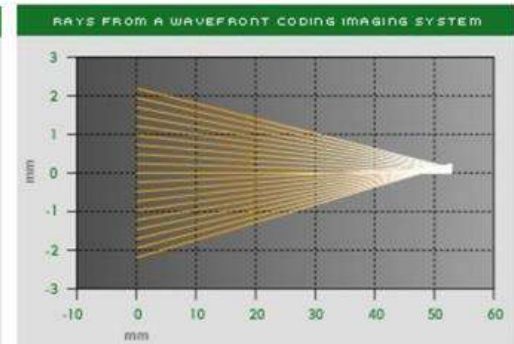
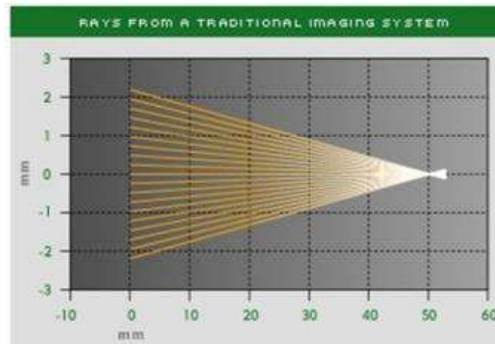
Replace lens with a cubic phase plate

Camera with generalized optics

Wavefront coding

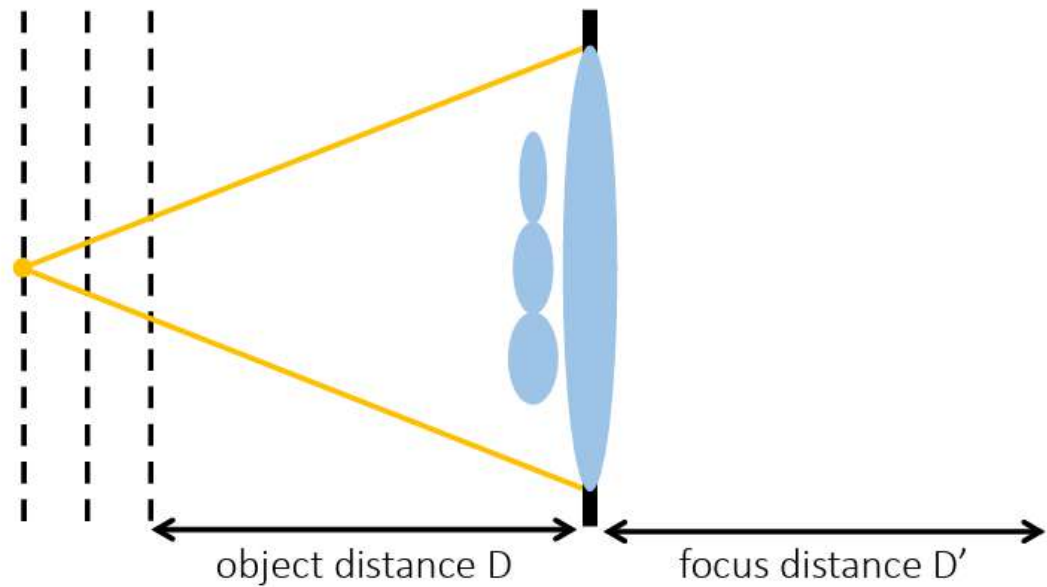


- Rays no longer converge.
- Approximately depth-invariant PSF for certain range of depths.



Camera with generalized optics

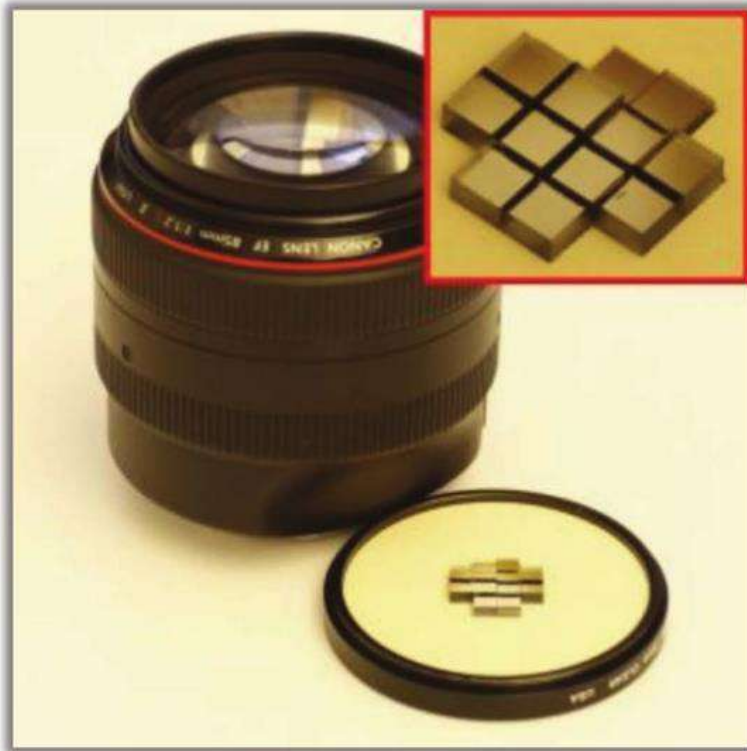
Lattice lens



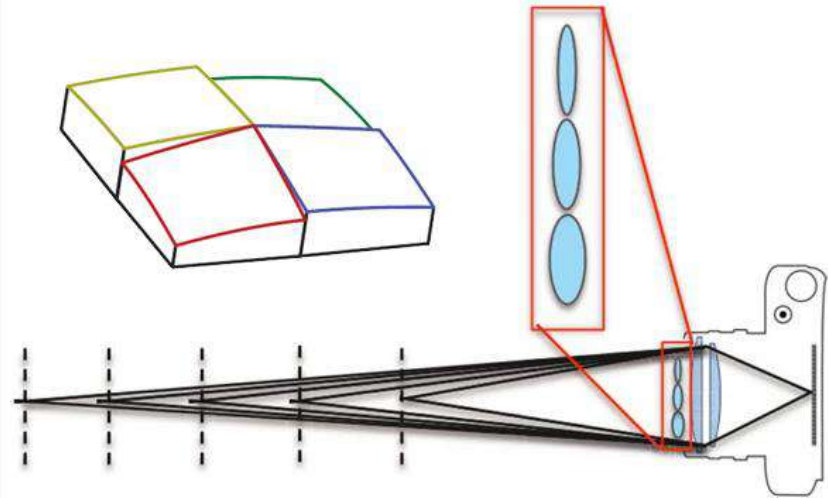
Add lenslet array with varying focal length in front of lens

Camera with generalized optics

Lattice lens



Does this remind you of something?



Camera with generalized optics

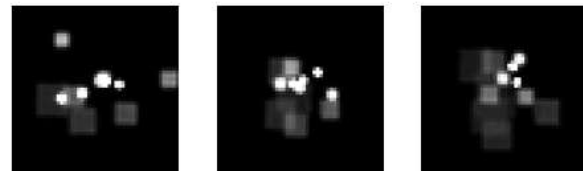
Lattice lens

- Effectively captures only the “useful” subset of the 4D lightfield.

Light field spectrum: 4D
Image spectrum: 2D
Depth: 1D } 3D
→ Dimensionality gap (Ng 05)
Only the 3D manifold corresponding to
physical focusing distance is useful

- PSF is not depth-invariant, so local deconvolution as in coded aperture.

PSFs at different depths



Camera with generalized optics

Results



Camera with generalized optics

Refocusing example



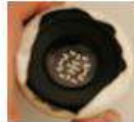
Camera with generalized optics

Depth of field comparison:



standard lens

<



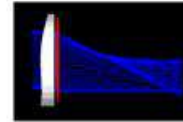
coded aperture

<<



focal sweep

<



wavefront coding

<

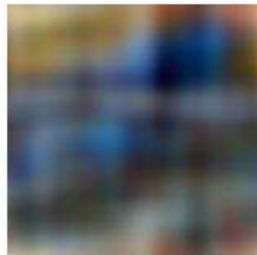


lattice lens

Object at in-focus depth



Object at extreme depth



References

- Computational Photography (Levoy, Adams, Pulli, Stanford)
- Computational Photography SIGGRAPH Course (Raskar & Tumblin)
- Digital and Computational Photography (Durand & Freeman, MIT)
- Computational Photography (Efros, CMU)
- Computational Photography (Gkioulekas, CMU)
- Computational Imaging (Wetzstein, Stanford)
- Computational Photography (Fergus, NYU)
- Computational Imaging (Dragotti, Imperial College)
- Computer Vision (Seitz & Szeliski, UWashington)
- Introduction to Visual Computing and Visual Modeling (Kutulakos, UToronto)